Research record: locality, terminal information, and planar exploration laws

Autonomous mathematical investigation, with independent critical checks

27 October 2026

Abstract

We study both the original fixed-target locality axiom and the corrected source-neighborhood locality introduced at commit `0e47018`. The old terminal-germ counterexample is excluded by the corrected axiom; its classification and critical percolation universality remain open. The continuation proves a conditional SLE_6 classification from regular absolutely continuous driving drift and local boundedness of its initial rate, with no assumed regularity of quadratic variation. Two shrinking slits yield explicit inverse-linear and inverse-cubic instability rates. A scaling argument also obstructs tame driving in a wrong affine coordinate system. Within the affine-SLE marginal ansatz, stability at one straight slit-tip germ suffices for a common metric. Further results quantify target stability under conditional crossing estimates, bound anisotropy from curve nonconcentration, and prove source-patch coalescence for common-color independent percolation using only RSW shields. Historical proofs, failed constructions, and all additional assumptions are retained explicitly.

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1 Scope, conventions, and verification status

Revision of the research question. The user strengthened locality in `PROJECT_DESCRIPTION.md`, commits `32f8e45` and `0e47018`. It now compares any two marked colored domains agreeing in a source neighborhood, allowing their targets to differ. Their stopped paths must agree until leaving that neighborhood. The terminal-germ counterexample in Section 3 is a historical result about the earlier fixed-target deletion axiom, and is *not* a counterexample to the corrected conjecture. Earlier references to "the proposed axioms" should be read with that historical scope. The new continuation below states its additional hypotheses explicitly.

This record starts from an otherwise empty research repository. The project specification is preserved unchanged. Its primary question is whether strong domain Markov, locality, and physical translation covariance force a domain-indexed family of exploration curves to be one fixed affine pullback of chordal SLE_6. We do not assume this conclusion or conformal covariance of an unknown family.

In the original investigation, curves are oriented, unparameterized continuous paths. After an initial exploration, the remaining domain is the component facing the terminal prime end, with the exposed tip interpreted as an appropriate prime end. The original fixed-target locality compares curves up to first encounter with a removed closed set; their respective capacity clocks need not agree. Deletions must preserve the source and terminal end neighborhoods and leave a simply connected target component. This is the customary precise setting for chordal locality. For a Jordan

target and a planar closed set disjoint from that point, preservation of its terminal neighborhood is automatic.

External facts used. We use existence, conformal covariance, strong domain Markov, locality, and continuous Loewner generation of ordinary SLE_6 as established theorems; see [1]. We use elementary conformal mapping, boundary extension on Jordan domains, harmonic uniqueness, and Morera's theorem. Loewner admissibility of affine images is justified explicitly using [2]. A reversal statement below additionally uses [3]. These external results are distinguished from the arguments proved here.

Proof checks. The target-germ construction was found independently in two investigations. The boundary-race computation and the single-domain metric-identification argument were checked independently, including the sign of the diffusion, the exclusion of simultaneous swallowing, and the boundary-extension step. The global-homeomorphism rigidity argument and the local boundary-twist test were also independently checked. These checks are evidence of correctness, not a replacement for expert human review. Nothing here proves universality for general critical percolation.

2 An affine metric is identifiable from one chordal law

For a bounded Jordan domain D, distinct $p, q \in \partial D$, and an orientation-preserving invertible real-linear map A, put

$$\nu^A_{D,p,q} = (A^{-1})_* \,\mathrm{Law}\big(\mathrm{SLE}_6(AD; Ap, Aq)\big). \tag{1}$$

Translations in an affine normalizer are immaterial. The tensor $A^{\mathsf{T}}A$ is its Euclidean conformal metric, determined only up to a positive scalar.

2.1 A boundary-swallowing race

Lemma 2.1 (Strict boundary-race probability)**.** *Let η be chordal SLE_6 in $\mathbb{H}$ from 0 to ∞. For $x < 0 < y$, let τ_x, τ_y denote their Loewner swallowing times. Then*

$$\mathbb{P}(\tau_y < \tau_x) = F\left(\frac{-x}{y-x}\right), \qquad F(r) = \frac{\int_0^r [u(1-u)]^{-2/3}\,du}{\int_0^1 [u(1-u)]^{-2/3}\,du}. \tag{2}$$

In particular F is strictly increasing on $(0,1)$. The event in (2) is invariant under orientation-preserving homeomorphisms of marked Jordan domains, when formulated as the order of separation from the terminal prime end by the filled exploration hull.

Proof. Use $\partial_t g_t(z) = 2/(g_t(z) - W_t)$ with $W_t = \sqrt{6}B_t$. Until the first swallowing time put

$$X_t = g_t(x) - W_t < 0, \quad Y_t = g_t(y) - W_t > 0, \quad T_t = Y_t - X_t, \quad R_t = -X_t/T_t \in (0,1).$$

Then

$$dX_t = \frac{2}{X_t}\,dt - \sqrt{6}\,dB_t, \qquad dY_t = \frac{2}{Y_t}\,dt - \sqrt{6}\,dB_t,$$
$$dT_t = \frac{2T_t}{-X_tY_t}\,dt > 0, \qquad dR_t = \frac{2(1-2R_t)}{R_t(1-R_t)T_t^2}\,dt + \frac{\sqrt{6}}{T_t}\,dB_t.$$

With $ds = dt/T_t^2$, the generator of R is

$$\mathcal{L} = 3\frac{d^2}{dr^2} + \frac{2(1-2r)}{r(1-r)}\frac{d}{dr}.$$

The increasing solution of $\mathcal{L}F = 0$, $F(0) = 0$, $F(1) = 1$ has $F'(r) = C[r(1-r)]^{-2/3}$, giving (2) by bounded optional stopping. To justify the terminal values, $|X|/\sqrt{6}$ and $Y/\sqrt{6}$ are Bessel processes of dimension $1 + 4/6 = 5/3$ up to their first zero; thus the first swallowing time is finite almost surely. Alternatively, the accessible endpoints of the displayed diffusion give the same stopping argument. There is no simultaneous swallowing, since $T_t \geq y - x > 0$, whereas both $X_t, Y_t \to 0$ would force $T_t \to 0$. At the first swallowing, $R = 1$ exactly when y is swallowed first. ODE solutions and the continuous driver stay finite up to that first time.

Swallowing means that the marked boundary end has been cut off from the target by the explored filled hull (including the boundary swallowed at first contact). This definition uses only the domain, the oriented path, and its order of traversal. A homeomorphism carries filled target components to filled target components. Capacity parametrization therefore has no role in the comparison event. □

2.2 Boundary rigidity and affine uniqueness

Lemma 2.2 (A single SLE law identifies its conformal boundary map)**.** *Let $h : \overline{D} \to \overline{D'}$ be an orientation-preserving homeomorphism between closed bounded Jordan domains, with $p' = h(p)$, $q' = h(q)$. If $h_*\mathrm{SLE}_6(D; p, q) = \mathrm{SLE}_6(D'; p', q')$, then $h|_{\partial D}$ agrees with the boundary extension of a conformal map $f : D \to D'$.*

Proof. Choose conformal maps $\phi : D \to \mathbb{H}$ and $\phi' : D' \to \mathbb{H}$ sending their marked endpoints to $0, \infty$. Their Jordan boundary extensions give an increasing homeomorphism

$$H = \phi' \circ h \circ \phi^{-1} : \overline{\mathbb{R}} \to \overline{\mathbb{R}}$$

fixing $0, \infty$. For every $x < 0 < y$, equality of the corresponding boundary-race probabilities and strictness in Lemma 2.1 give

$$\frac{-H(x)}{H(y) - H(x)} = \frac{-x}{y - x}, \quad \text{hence} \quad \frac{H(x)}{H(y)} = \frac{x}{y}.$$

Fixing one $x < 0$ and one $y > 0$ shows $H(s) = cs$ for all real s, with $c > 0$. Consequently $f = (\phi')^{-1} \circ (c\phi)$ has exactly the required boundary values. Equality of interior maps is not asserted for an arbitrary h. □

Theorem 2.3 (Single-domain affine identifiability)**.** *For even one bounded Jordan D and one pair of distinct boundary points p, q, the equality $\nu^A_{D,p,q} = \nu^B_{D,p,q}$ holds if and only if BA^{-1} is a Euclidean similarity. Equivalently,*

$$B^\mathsf{T}B = cA^\mathsf{T}A \qquad (c > 0).$$

The statement also allows orientation-reversing normalizers by composing one map with a reflection.

Proof. The equality of laws means $M = BA^{-1}$ carries the SLE law in AD to the SLE law in BD, at the corresponding endpoints. By Lemma 2.2, a conformal map $f : AD \to BD$ has boundary values equal to M. Both real coordinate functions of the real-linear map M are harmonic. The real and imaginary parts of f are also harmonic, continuous on the closure, with the same boundary values. The maximum principle on the bounded domain gives $f = M$ throughout AD. Thus M is complex-linear and invertible, hence a similarity. The converse is ordinary SLE similarity covariance. Reflection covariance reduces the remaining orientation case to this one. □

3 A counterexample to the original fixed-target locality

3.1 The conserved information and the admissible domain class

Let $G(D, q)$ be the embedded germ of D at its terminal prime end. Concretely, target neighborhoods may be taken as

$$f^{-1}\big(\mathbb{H} \setminus \overline{B(0, R)}\big), \qquad R \to \infty,$$

for any conformal $f : D \to \mathbb{H}$ sending q to infinity. The embedded germ records the planar domain in a full neighborhood of that end; one may shrink neighborhoods without changing it. A full neighborhood contains a neighborhood in the prime-end compactification, rather than merely an arbitrarily narrow approach sector. Germ equivalence means agreement on such neighborhoods with the same inherited marked end.

At a Jordan boundary point this is the ordinary local boundary germ. At a slit tip one must retain which prime end is intended. A germ is called C^1-regular here when it has a singleton endpoint and, in a full end neighborhood, a single C^1 boundary arc with a nonzero tangent and the domain locally on one side. The tangent line $\ell(G)$ is unoriented. All other germs receive the default label below. Regularity and tangent are properties of the germ itself.

Finite chordal Loewner hulls in a target-normalized half-plane chart are bounded. They therefore miss some target neighborhood. At every finite stopping time prior to reaching the target, the remaining marked domain D_t satisfies

$$G(D_t, q) = G(D, q). \tag{3}$$

Likewise locality deletions away from the terminal end preserve this germ. Thus the following proof already works on domains with regular targets, together with their slit domains, a class closed under all operations needed in the argument. Assigning defaults to nonregular end germs extends it to arbitrary prime ends under the stated end-neighborhood convention. Locality for sets accumulating at a nonsingleton impression must always be formulated in prime-end terms; it is not defined by pretending the end is a single physical point.

Proposition 3.1 (Conserved-label construction)**.** *Assign to each embedded terminal germ an orientation-preserving invertible real-linear map $A(G)$, measurably and in a translation-covariant way: $A(G(D + v, q + v)) = A(G(D, q))$. Define*

$$P_{D,p,q} = (A(G(D, q))^{-1})_* \mathrm{SLE}_6\big(A(G(D, q))D; A(G(D, q))p, A(G(D, q))q\big). \tag{4}$$

Then this family has strong domain Markov, locality, and translation covariance as unparameterized paths.

Proof. Write $A = A(G(D, q))$. By (3) the same deterministic A is prescribed after any finite initial exploration. Apply strong domain Markov to SLE_6 in AD, then pull the tail back by A^{-1}. This gives exactly (4) in the remaining target component, at its exposed tip and target. Stopping times are carried to stopping times because the invertible map preserves the explored filtration; the capacity clock is an adapted increasing time change. For deletion of K away from both ends, the two domains use the same A. SLE_6 locality in AD and $AD \setminus AK$, pulled back by A^{-1}, couples their paths identically until first encounter with K. Finally the displayed covariance of the label and translation covariance of SLE_6 prove physical translation covariance. No conditioning on a hidden random parameter occurs: the label is a deterministic conserved function of the current marked domain. □

3.2 A concrete example with full similarity covariance

Fix $a > 0$, $a \neq 1$, and set

$$A(G) = \begin{cases} \Pi_{\ell(G)} + a\Pi_{\ell(G)^\perp}, & G \text{ is } C^1\text{-regular}, \\ I, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

Here Π is orthogonal projection. On smooth-target domains this is a continuous function of the tangent in the topology controlling that tangent; on arbitrary germs it is a deterministic local geometric rule. If desired, the class can first be restricted to piecewise smooth domains and their finite slit descendants, avoiding any measurable-space conventions for the class of all planar domains.

For a similarity $S(x) = cRx + v$, $c > 0$, R orthogonal, one has

$$A(G(SD, Sq)) = RA(G(D, q))R^{-1}.$$

Combining this with SLE_6 similarity and reflection covariance proves $P_{SD,Sp,Sq} = S_* P_{D,p,q}$. Thus adding scale invariance, reflection covariance, or covariance under every rotation does not exclude this construction.

Theorem 3.2 (The proposed fixed-affine classification is false)**.** *The ensemble (4)–(5) satisfies the three proposed axioms, and full Euclidean similarity covariance, but there is no one fixed affine transformation sending all its laws to ordinary chordal SLE_6. This failure already occurs for smooth targets on one disk.*

Proof. Take D to be the unit disk and fix $p = -1$. At $q_h = i$ the tangent is horizontal, while at $q_v = 1$ it is vertical. The respective matrices are

$$A_h = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & a \end{pmatrix}, \qquad A_v = \begin{pmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

A fixed affine normalizer with linear part B would imply $\nu^B_{D,p,q_h} = \nu^{A_h}_{D,p,q_h}$ and $\nu^B_{D,p,q_v} = \nu^{A_v}_{D,p,q_v}$. Theorem 2.3 makes both BA_h^{-1} and BA_v^{-1} similarities. Hence $A_v A_h^{-1} = \mathrm{diag}(a, a^{-1})$ would be a similarity, forcing $a^2 = 1$, contrary to $a > 0$, $a \neq 1$. □

3.3 Why these really are continuous-driving Loewner curves

Continuity and the absence of transverse crossings alone would not suffice to settle this point. Instead use the deterministic characterization in [2, Theorem 1.1 and Remark 1.4]: a continuous half-plane path with strictly increasing filled hulls is a continuous-driving Loewner trace if and only if it is a locally uniform limit of simple interior paths. The condition is independent of parametrization.

An ordinary SLE_6 trace has this property. Conjugating an invertible affine map by the conformal charts of its source and image domains gives a quasiconformal self-map of $\mathbb{H}$. It extends to a homeomorphism of the closed half-plane with its point at infinity, fixing the two marked ends after normalization. It carries simple interior approximants to simple interior approximants; uniform convergence survives on compact time intervals because the extended map is uniformly continuous on relevant compact sets. Filled hulls and their strict growth are topologically preserved. Yuan's theorem gives a continuous driving function after reparametrizing by capacity. This also treats nonsmooth slit domains in the Markov property without assuming Euclidean continuity of their uniformizing maps on every boundary point. The counterexample therefore applies to the driving-function formulation as well as to curves.

3.4 Quasiconformal images have infinite capacity lifetime

Yuan's characterization gives a continuous Loewner driver after recoding an affine image by its capacity, but this alone does not assert that the capacity lifetime is infinite. A continuous curve tending to infinity need not have infinite half-plane capacity. The following argument proves the required assertion for the quasiconformal changes arising here.

Lemma 3.3. *Let $F : \mathbb{H} \to \mathbb{H}$ be a fixed K-quasiconformal self-homeomorphism whose boundary extension fixes 0 and ∞. If η is ordinary chordal SLE$_6$ from 0 to ∞, then $F\eta$ has unbounded imaginary part almost surely. Consequently its half-plane-capacity lifetime is infinite.*

Proof. Put $C = \overline{B(i, 1/4)} \subset \mathbb{H}$. The boundary map of F is increasing, so $F(R) > 0$ for $R > 0$ and $F(R) \to +\infty$ as $R \to \infty$. The normalized maps

$$F_R(z) = \frac{F(Rz)}{F(R)}$$

are K-quasiconformal half-plane maps fixing $0, 1, \infty$. Reflecting them across the real line gives normalized quasiconformal sphere maps. Compactness of this normalized family, including its inverses, implies

$$\inf_{R>0} \inf_{z\in C} \operatorname{Im} F_R(z) = c_K > 0.$$

Indeed, a sequence violating positivity would have a subsequence converging uniformly on the sphere to a quasiconformal homeomorphism preserving the half-plane, and a subsequence of points in C would then be mapped to its real boundary, an impossibility. Hence

$$\inf_{z\in RC} \operatorname{Im} F(z) \geq c_K F(R) \longrightarrow \infty. \tag{QC1}$$

The event $E = \{\eta \cap C \neq \varnothing\}$ has positive probability. One elementary justification avoids invoking a support theorem. In the normalization $\partial_t g_t = 2/(g_t - W_t)$, the Brownian event

$$\sup_{0\leq t\leq 1} |W_t| < \varepsilon, \qquad 0 < \varepsilon < 1/4,$$

has positive probability. On this event the Loewner hull stays within the vertical strip $|\operatorname{Re} z| \leq \varepsilon$ up to time 1. For example, a point initially to the right of that strip has increasing real part under the Loewner ODE and retains a positive real gap from the driver, so it cannot be swallowed in finite time; the other side is identical. If the entire trace up to time 1 had height at most 1, its filled hull would lie in the half-disk of radius $\sqrt{1+\varepsilon^2}$. By capacity monotonicity its capacity would be at most $1 + \varepsilon^2 < 2$, whereas its actual capacity is 2. Here a half-disk of radius R has hydrodynamic map $z + R^2/z$ and capacity R^2. Thus the continuous trace crosses height 1 in the strip, and that crossing lies in C.

Fix $r > 1$. Brownian scaling, and therefore scalar dilation of ordinary SLE$_6$, is mixing. Indeed $Z_s = e^{-s/2} B_{e^s}$, $s \in \mathbb{R}$, is a stationary Gaussian process with covariance $e^{-|s-u|/2}$; scalar Brownian scaling becomes a log-time shift. Decay of these covariances gives mixing first for Gaussian cylinder functions and then for the whole path sigma-field. Its inverse dilation is ergodic as well. Birkhoff's theorem applied to 1_E gives

$$\eta \cap r^n C \neq \varnothing \qquad \text{for infinitely many positive integers } n, \quad \text{almost surely.}$$

In fact these visits have limiting positive frequency, since $1_E(S_{r^{-n}}\eta) = 1_{\{\eta\cap r^n C\neq\varnothing\}}$. Equation (QC1) then shows that $F\eta$ has unbounded height.

Every finite initial image trace is compact away from infinity and has finite capacity. The standard Loewner height estimate

$$\max\{\operatorname{Im} z : z \in K\}^2 \le 2\operatorname{hcap}(K)$$

for a half-plane hull, or equivalently $\max \operatorname{Im} K_u \le 2\sqrt{u}$ when $\operatorname{hcap}(K_u) = 2u$, now forces the capacities of these image prefixes to tend to infinity. Thus the capacity-recoded image has lifetime $[0, \infty)$. □

For an affine image in a bounded marked domain, conjugating the affine map by its source and image conformal charts gives exactly such a fixed quasiconformal F fixing the marked ends. This lemma therefore completes the infinite-time driving-function assertion for the target-germ counterexample. It uses properties of SLE_6, rather than an invalid general assertion about arbitrary curves tending to infinity.

4 A positive classification within the global-deformation class

The preceding example does not arise from one deterministic global change of spatial coordinates. Within that narrower class the proposed affine conclusion does follow, and no differentiability of the change of coordinates is required.

Theorem 4.1 (Full-family homeomorphism symmetries are conformal)**.** *Let $h : \mathbb{C} \to \mathbb{C}$ be an orientation-preserving homeomorphism such that, for every bounded Jordan domain and marked boundary pair,*

$$h_*\mathrm{SLE}_6(D; p, q) = \mathrm{SLE}_6(hD; hp, hq).$$

Then h is an entire conformal automorphism, hence $h(z) = \alpha z + \beta$ for complex $\alpha \neq 0$. For an orientation-reversing homeomorphism, the corresponding conclusion is anticonformality.

Proof. Take any nondegenerate closed Euclidean triangle T and distinct $p, q \in \partial T$. Lemma 2.2 gives a conformal $f_T : T^\circ \to h(T^\circ)$ whose continuous boundary extension equals h on ∂T. Cauchy's theorem, applied on interior triangles and then passed to the boundary by continuity, yields

$$\int_{\partial T} h(z)\, dz = \int_{\partial T} f_T(z)\, dz = 0.$$

Since h is continuous and this holds for every triangle, Morera's theorem makes h entire holomorphic. Its injectivity makes it conformal, and an entire conformal automorphism of the plane is complex affine. Composition with a reflection proves the other orientation case. □

Theorem 4.2 (Stationary global deformations are real affine)**.** *Let $h : \mathbb{C} \to \mathbb{C}$ be a homeomorphism and define, on all bounded Jordan domains,*

$$P^h_{D,p,q} = (h^{-1})_*\mathrm{SLE}_6(hD; hp, hq).$$

If this ensemble is covariant under every physical translation, then h is a real-affine homeomorphism.

Proof. Reflection covariance lets us assume h preserves orientation. For every $v \in \mathbb{C}$, physical translation covariance says that

$$\psi_v = h \circ T_v \circ h^{-1}, \qquad T_v(z) = z + v,$$

preserves the full chordal SLE_6 family. All bounded Jordan domains are available, since inverse images under a plane homeomorphism are bounded Jordan domains. Theorem 4.1 gives $\psi_v(z) = \alpha_v z + \beta_v$. For $v \neq 0$, the conjugate of a nonzero translation has no fixed point. A complex affine map with $\alpha_v \neq 1$ has a fixed point, so $\alpha_v = 1$ for all v. It follows that $h(x+v) = h(x) + \beta_v$, and putting $x = 0$ gives

$$h(x+v) - h(0) = (h(x) - h(0)) + (h(v) - h(0)).$$

The continuous additive map $h - h(0)$ is real-linear. It is invertible because h is a homeomorphism. □

What this does not prove. The original axioms do not give a representation by one global h. The counterexample shows that replacing a domain-dependent geometry by one fixed spatial geometry is a substantive missing step, not an innocent coordinate choice.

5 Boundary stability and other ways to remove terminal dependence

5.1 An explicit failure of continuity under small target perturbations

The tangent rule is continuous when target tangents converge, but not under ordinary uniform approximation of the domains and their boundaries. This defect persists even when every domain is smooth and the approximating domains are uniform quasidisks.

Proposition 5.1 (Local rotation of a terminal germ)**.** *For the ensemble of Theorem 3.2, there are smooth Jordan $D_n \to D$, with uniformly converging boundary parametrizations and fixed distinct marked points p, q, for which $P_{D_n,p,q}$ does not converge to $P_{D,p,q}$ in the uniform unparameterized-curve topology.*

Proof. Let D be the unit disk, $q = i$, $p = -1$. Choose a smooth radial cutoff χ equal to 1 near 0 and 0 outside the unit disk, and define the orientation-preserving smooth diffeomorphism

$$F(re^{i\theta}) = r\exp\bigl(i\theta + i(\pi/2)\chi(r)\bigr).$$

It is a rotation by $\pi/2$ near 0 and the identity outside the disk. Its quasiconformal distortion is finite, since $r\chi'(r)$ is bounded. Put $F_\epsilon(z) = q + \epsilon F((z-q)/\epsilon)$ and $D_\epsilon = F_\epsilon(D)$. Then $F_\epsilon(q) = q$, and $F_\epsilon(p) = p$ for small ϵ, while $\sup_z |F_\epsilon(z) - z| \leq 2\epsilon$. All F_ϵ have one common quasiconformal bound. At q the target tangent has rotated by $\pi/2$, so the matrix used for every D_ϵ is A_v, whereas the matrix for D is A_h.

The domains $A_v D_\epsilon$ are uniform quasidisks converging to $A_v D$, with the marked boundary points converging as well. Kernel convergence and uniform boundary equicontinuity of normalized Riemann maps on uniform quasidisks give uniform convergence of these maps on the closed disk. Coupling their chordal SLE_6 paths with one common disk SLE path therefore gives convergence of the entire unparameterized curves. Thus

$$P_{D_\epsilon,p,q} \implies \nu^{A_v}_{D,p,q}.$$

By Theorem 2.3, this limit differs from $P_{D,p,q} = \nu^{A_h}_{D,p,q}$ because $A_v A_h^{-1} = \mathrm{diag}(a, a^{-1})$ is not a similarity. □

This proves that an appropriate boundary-stability requirement excludes the example. It does not prove that boundary stability plus the three original axioms suffices for classification.

Corollary 5.2 (Boundary stability classifies tangent-dependent affine laws)**.** *Suppose, on smooth bounded Jordan domains with smooth targets, an ensemble has the form* $P_{D,p,q} = \nu_{D,p,q}^{A_{\ell(D,q)}}$*, where* A_ℓ *is an arbitrary orientation-preserving invertible linear map depending only on the unoriented target tangent line. If these laws are continuous under the uniform smooth-boundary approximations used in Proposition 5.1, then one fixed affine map normalizes all of them. If the ensemble is also covariant under all rotations, that fixed map is a similarity.*

Proof. Given any two tangent lines ℓ_1, ℓ_2, take a disk having tangent ℓ_1 at q and apply the preceding local twist with the rotation carrying ℓ_1 to ℓ_2. Every approximating domain uses the constant matrix A_{ℓ_2}. SLE continuity in that fixed metric shows that the limiting law is $\nu_{D,p,q}^{A_{\ell_2}}$, whereas the assumed boundary stability makes it $\nu_{D,p,q}^{A_{\ell_1}}$. Single-pair identifiability implies $A_{\ell_2} A_{\ell_1}^{-1}$ is a similarity. Thus all $A_\ell^{\mathsf{T}} A_\ell$ are proportional, which is exactly one fixed affine family. For rotation covariance its fixed tensor Q satisfies $R^{\mathsf{T}} Q R = Q$ for every rotation R, by the same metric uniqueness, hence Q is scalar. □

5.2 Reversibility eliminates this mechanism inside the affine-germ ansatz

Here is a rigorous limitation of the constructed counterexamples, useful for formulating a more faithful percolation classification. Suppose

$$P_{D,p,q} = A(D,q)_*^{-1} \mathrm{SLE}_6(AD; Ap, Aq)$$

on bounded Jordan domains, and suppose this family is reversible: reversing $P_{D,p,q}$ gives $P_{D,q,p}$. Then, for all p, q,

$$A(D,p)^T A(D,p) = c(D,p,q) A(D,q)^T A(D,q), \qquad c(D,p,q) > 0.$$

Use here the external reversibility theorem of J. Miller and S. Sheffield, *Imaginary geometry III: reversibility of SLE$_\kappa$ for $\kappa \in (4,8)$*, Annals of Mathematics 184 (2016), 455–486, https://annals.math.princeton.edu/2016/184-2/p03. Indeed, ordinary SLE_6 reversibility says that reversing the first curve uses the same matrix $A(D,q)$, now with endpoints q, p. By assumed reversibility this is equal to the law constructed with $A(D,p)$. Single-pair affine identifiability therefore says that $A(D,p)A(D,q)^{-1}$ is a similarity, which is equivalent to the displayed matrix relation. For a rectangle with one endpoint in a horizontal side and the other in a vertical side, the proposed matrices $\mathrm{diag}(1,a)$ and $\mathrm{diag}(a,1)$ violate this relation when $a \neq 1$. Thus the construction explicitly fails reversibility.

This result only eliminates endpoint-dependent anisotropy *within this ansatz*; it does not prove the desired classification after reversibility is added. Near-critical percolation suggests a separate criticality condition remains necessary.

6 Further affine rigidity and target consistency

The following argument concerns ordinary chordal SLE_6; it does not assume conformal invariance of an unknown exploration family. For SLE_6 in $\mathbb{H}$ from 0 to ∞, the left-passage event $L(z)$ is defined by the eventual side of the oriented trace containing z. For a nonsimple trace this is also its eventual Loewner swallowing side. It is invariant under orientation-preserving homeomorphisms of the marked half-plane. A fixed interior point belongs to the trace with probability zero.

Lemma 6.1 (Strict left-passage function)**.** *For $z = x + iy$, $y > 0$,*

$$\mathbb{P}[L(z)] = F(x/y), \qquad F(u) = \frac{\int_{-\infty}^{u}(1+v^2)^{-2/3}\,dv}{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty}(1+v^2)^{-2/3}\,dv}.$$

In particular, F is strictly increasing.

Proof. This is the standard SLE left-passage formula; its short diffusion derivation explains why strict monotonicity holds even for the nonsimple SLE_6 trace. Write $g_t(z) - \sqrt{\kappa}B_t = X_t + iY_t$. Then

$$dX_t = \frac{2X_t}{X_t^2 + Y_t^2}\,dt - \sqrt{\kappa}\,dB_t, \qquad dY_t = -\frac{2Y_t}{X_t^2 + Y_t^2}\,dt.$$

For $U = X/Y$ and $ds = dt/Y_t^2$, Itô's formula gives

$$dU_s = \frac{4U_s}{1+U_s^2}\,ds - \sqrt{\kappa}\,d\widetilde{B}_s.$$

The increasing scale function with limits $0, 1$ solves

$$\frac{\kappa}{2}F'' + \frac{4u}{1+u^2}F' = 0, \qquad F'(u) = C_\kappa(1+u^2)^{-4/\kappa}.$$

The normalizing integral is finite for $\kappa < 8$. The clock runs to infinity up to the point's maximal Loewner lifetime: otherwise $d\log Y_s = -2(1+U_s^2)^{-1}ds$ keeps Y positive and the diffusion extends. The bounded martingale $F(U_s)$ converges. A limit in $(0,1)$ would force U_s to converge to a finite value and its martingale quadratic variation to be infinite, a contradiction. Thus $U_s \to -\infty$ or $+\infty$. Optional stopping and the usual topological side identification for chordal Loewner chains give the formula at $\kappa = 6$. □

Proposition 6.2 (Linear symmetries of half-plane SLE_6)**.** *If an invertible real-linear map M carries $SLE_6(\mathbb{H}, 0, \infty)$ to $SLE_6(M\mathbb{H}, 0, \infty)$, then M is a Euclidean similarity, possibly reversing orientation.*

Proof. Reflection invariance reduces to $\det M > 0$. Rotate $M\mathbb{H}$ back to $\mathbb{H}$. The resulting map is $T(x,y) = (ax + by, cy)$ with $a, c > 0$. By topological preservation of the side event and Lemma 6.1,

$$F(u) = F((au+b)/c) \qquad (u \in \mathbb{R}).$$

Strict monotonicity implies $a = c$, $b = 0$. Undo the rotation. □

6.1 Target consistency is a substantive additional condition

Additional axiom; not a consequence proved here. For two targets q_1, q_2 on a boundary arc J whose closure avoids p, require explorations towards them to couple identically until first hitting J (or use the usual stopping formulation before target separation). A common percolation coloring gives this: the two boundary conditions disagree only on J, so the exploration algorithms see identical colors until reaching it. The stated locality axiom fixes q and does not assert this property.

Proposition 6.3 (Target consistency removes variable affine target metrics)**.** *Suppose D is a bounded Jordan domain analytic near p, and*

$$\mathcal{P}_{D,p,q} = (A_q^{-1})_*\,\mathrm{SLE}_6(A_qD, A_qp, A_qq).$$

If target consistency holds for q_1, q_2 on an arc avoiding p, then $A_{q_2}A_{q_1}^{-1}$ is a similarity. In particular, their metric tensors $A_q^{\mathsf{T}}A_q$ are proportional.

Proof. Translate p to zero and dilate by $r \to \infty$. The domains converge locally to the tangent half-plane H_p, and targets tend to infinity. For each fixed q, conformal kernel convergence at the analytic start and the usual initial-segment construction of SLE give limiting law

$$(A_q^{-1})_* \operatorname{SLE}_6(A_q H_p, 0, \infty).$$

Convergence can be tested on paths stopped on crosscuts strictly inside fixed half-disks, followed by exhaustion. The dilated disagreement arc escapes every fixed neighborhood, so target consistency says that the two limiting half-plane laws coincide. Apply A_{q_1}, rotate the image half-plane, and use Proposition 6.2. □

This eliminates the specific target-tangent obstruction, not every possible counterexample. The proof uses initial-segment convergence for ordinary SLE_6, not for an unknown general ensemble.

6.2 A compatibility graph for all target-germ affine decorations

The previous target-consistency proposition also gives a useful classification within the entire class of affine decorations, without a claim about arbitrary exploration ensembles. Define a graph whose vertices are admissible embedded target germs, modulo translations, and join G_1, G_2 when they can both occur on one bounded Jordan domain with an analytic starting point p elsewhere. The targets must lie on a boundary arc whose closure avoids p. Assign to each vertex the projective positive-definite tensor $[Q(G)] = [A(G)^{\mathsf{T}} A(G)]$.

Corollary 6.4 (Target-germ metrics are constant on compatibility components)**.** *For a target-germ affine SLE_6 decoration satisfying target consistency, $[Q(G)]$ is constant on every connected component of this graph. If the graph is connected, the decoration is one fixed-affine SLE_6 family.*

Proof. Proposition 6.3 makes the tensors proportional across every edge. Propagate along finite paths. If a component has representative matrix A_0, proportionality implies $A(G) = c_G R_G A_0$ with $c_G > 0$ and R_G orthogonal. Similarity covariance of SLE_6 then gives

$$A(G)_*^{-1} \operatorname{SLE}_6(A(G)D, A(G)p, A(G)q) = (A_0^{-1})_* \operatorname{SLE}_6(A_0 D, A_0 p, A_0 q),$$

independently of G. □

For ordinary smooth local boundary germs, connectivity is suggested by a simple planar surgery: place two small representatives far apart, retain their marked local boundary arcs, join the remaining endpoints with disjoint arcs to form one Jordan boundary, and place an analytic start on a joining arc. A fully general surgery statement for nonlocally connected prime-end impressions is not asserted here; the graph formulation keeps this issue explicit. For the straight-line tangent germs in the counterexample, joint realization on an ordinary rounded rectangle already connects horizontal and vertical targets and excludes their distinct tensors.

6.3 Finite rotations and a fixed anisotropy

Proposition 6.5. *Suppose an ensemble has one fixed affine SLE_6 normalization with linear part A, and is covariant under rotation R_θ, where $\theta \notin \pi\mathbb{Z}$. Then $A^{\mathsf{T}}A$ is scalar, so A is a similarity. A half-turn alone does not suffice.*

Proof. The map $AR_\theta A^{-1}$ preserves the SLE_6 family and hence is a similarity. Its determinant is 1, so it is orthogonal. For $Q = A^{\mathsf{T}}A$ this says $R_\theta^{\mathsf{T}} Q R_\theta = Q$. A symmetric real 2×2 matrix commuting with a rotation other than 0 or π is scalar. For $R_\pi = -I$, every Q satisfies the relation. □

The fixed-normalizer hypothesis is essential: the target-tangent construction can be covariant under every rotation and still have no fixed normalizer. Rotation symmetry by itself does not repair the conjecture.

7 What locality actually says about a semimartingale driving process

Status. The coordinate-change identities below are proved, under explicitly stated continuous-semimartingale assumptions. The conditional martingale theorem does not require absolute continuity of quadratic variation. They give a conditional SLE classification. The original three axioms do not currently imply these semimartingale or local-martingale assumptions, and no such implication is claimed. In particular the domain Markov property does not make a driving process Markov in its single real coordinate.

7.1 Deletion of a hull and the drift anomaly

Use chordal Loewner normalization

$$\partial_t g_t(z) = \frac{2}{g_t(z) - W_t}, \qquad g_t(z) = z + \frac{2t}{z} + O(z^{-2}).$$

Suppose on an interval before collision with a fixed hull that

$$dW_t = dM_t + b_t\,dt, \qquad d\langle M\rangle_t = v_t\,dt, \tag{L1}$$

where M is a continuous local martingale and $v_t \geq 0$. Let A be a bounded half-plane hull away from the initial tip, and let $h_0 : \mathbb{H} \setminus A \to \mathbb{H}$ have hydrodynamic normalization at infinity. Grow the same trace in the deleted domain, mapping by h_0 first, and denote its Loewner maps by $\widehat{g}_u$. Up to the first encounter with A, write

$$h_t = \widehat{g}_{u(t)} \circ h_0 \circ g_t^{-1}, \qquad \widehat{W}_{u(t)} = h_t(W_t), \qquad \dot{u}(t) = h_t'(W_t)^2. \tag{L2}$$

The map h_t is analytic across the real line near W_t, by Schwarz reflection, and $h_t'(W_t) > 0$. These formulas are local near the driving point; no differentiability of the trace is used.

Differentiating the composition in (L2) gives

$$\partial_t h_t(z) = \frac{2h_t'(W_t)^2}{h_t(z) - h_t(W_t)} - \frac{2h_t'(z)}{z - W_t}. \tag{L3}$$

For $z = W_t + \epsilon$ the first term is $2h_t'(W_t)/\epsilon - h_t''(W_t) + O(\epsilon)$, while the second term is $2h_t'(W_t)/\epsilon + 2h_t''(W_t) + O(\epsilon)$. Consequently

$$(\partial_t h_t)(W_t) = -3h_t''(W_t). \tag{L4}$$

The random field $h_t(z)$ has finite variation in time locally before collision, so ordinary Itô's formula (equivalently the finite-variation case of Itô–Wentzell) applies to $h_t(W_t)$. Thus

$$d\widehat{W}_{u(t)} = h_t'(W_t)\,dM_t + \left[h_t'(W_t)b_t + \left(\frac{v_t}{2} - 3\right)h_t''(W_t)\right]dt. \tag{L5}$$

After the capacity time change, its characteristics are therefore

$$\boxed{\widehat{v}_{u(t)} = v_t, \qquad \widehat{b}_{u(t)} = \frac{b_t}{h_t'(W_t)} + \left(\frac{v_t}{2} - 3\right)\frac{h_t''(W_t)}{h_t'(W_t)^2}.} \tag{L6}$$

The coefficient -3, and hence the exceptional variance 6, follow from the normalization $\partial_t g_t = 2/(g_t - W_t)$. A different capacity normalization changes both constants consistently.

Logical content. Locality identifies the law of the transformed driving process with the law prescribed for the deleted physical domain in its own conformal chart. It does *not* identify that law with the original driving law in its original chart. In particular the two drifts in (L6) need not vanish, or be equal. A geometry-dependent drift can transform with the second term in (L6); deleting that term without an additional hypothesis is exactly where an invalid proof of $v = 6$ would enter. Physical translation invariance acts by translating the physical domain and trace. It supplies no invariance under the nonlinear map h_t and cannot by itself justify identifying these two characteristics.

7.2 A precise conditional classification by driving martingales

Conditional theorem (proved).
Suppose an ensemble of continuous Loewner-generating chordal traces satisfies strong domain Markov and locality, with the conventional endpoint-preserving hull deletions. Suppose also that, for every deterministic marked domain, its capacity driving process in a chordal conformal chart is a continuous local martingale in its natural filtration. Assume the usual measurability and restart consistency of this family, so that the strong domain Markov property applies in the chart at a random slit domain. Then

$$W_t - W_0 = \sqrt{6}\, B_t,$$

and the ensemble is ordinary chordal SLE_6. No absolute continuity or differentiability assumption on quadratic variation is needed. The chart premise is independent of which chordal chart is selected, since two such charts differ by $z \mapsto az + b$, $a > 0$, and the corresponding deterministic capacity time change preserves local martingales.

Proof. Fix an initial marked domain and map it to $(\mathbb{H}, 0, \infty)$. Delete the inverse image of a vertical slit at $x \neq 0$, of height $2\sqrt{s}$ for $s > 0$. The hydrodynamic map of this slit is

$$h_0(z) = x + \sqrt{(z-x)^2 + 4s}, \tag{L7}$$

with the branch asymptotic to $z - x$ at infinity. At zero,

$$h_0'(0) = \frac{|x|}{\sqrt{x^2+4s}}, \qquad h_0''(0) = -\frac{4s\ \mathrm{sgn}(x)}{(x^2+4s)^{3/2}} \neq 0. \tag{L8}$$

Let $C_t = \langle W \rangle_t$, initially with no regularity beyond the continuity and monotonicity of quadratic variation. The general Itô version of (L5) is

$$d\widehat{W}_{u(t)} = h_t'(W_t)\, dW_t + \frac{1}{2} h_t''(W_t)\, dC_t - 3h_t''(W_t)\, dt. \tag{L8a}$$

By locality and the hypothesis on the deleted domain, $\widehat{W}_u$ is a continuous local martingale; its time change $\widehat{W}_{u(t)}$ is a local martingale in the same trace filtration. Indeed, the inverse clock $t(u)$ is the original-domain capacity of the initial trace reconstructed from the deleted-domain curve. It is an adapted, continuous increasing functional of that trace, so $u(t)$ is a stopping time in the deleted-driver filtration. The usual stopping-time change theorem, after localization, therefore applies. That filtration is also the one generated by W_t, since each driving function determines its initial hull and trace. Localizing before collision and before the chart derivatives become unbounded, the stochastic integral in (L8a) is a local martingale. Its remaining continuous finite-variation term must therefore vanish identically. As signed measures,

$$h_t''(W_t)\big(dC_t - 6\, dt\big) = 0. \tag{L8b}$$

The second derivative starts nonzero by (L8) and remains so on a positive, possibly random, initial time interval. Equation (L8b) proves $C_t = 6t$ on that interval.

This conclusion applies at the start of every deterministic marked domain. To propagate it without any density assumption, set

$$T = \inf\{t \geq 0 : C_t - 6t \neq 0\}, \qquad \inf \varnothing = \infty.$$

In the usual right-continuous filtration this is a stopping time: the first entrance time of the continuous adapted process $C_t - 6t$ into the open set $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$. The positive initial zero interval shows $T > 0$ almost surely. If $T < \infty$, continuity implies $C_T - 6T = 0$, and by the definition of T there must be nonzero values arbitrarily soon after T. Restarting the exploration at T using the strong domain Markov property gives a positive interval on which $C_{T+s} - C_T = 6s$, a contradiction. (One may localize T before deterministic bounds and before any terminal time.) Hence $C_t = 6t$ throughout. Lévy's characterization now gives the asserted Brownian driving law, and the Loewner correspondence identifies the trace as chordal SLE_6. □

Translation invariance was not needed in this conditional theorem. The additional condition is substantial: it asks for local martingales *in the conformal charts of all physical domains*, not just one chosen half-plane. A possible route toward universality would be to derive such a martingale condition from suitable physical observables. Nothing in this calculation constructs those observables.

7.3 A constant-characteristic version and an explicit two-slit test

A related sufficient assumption is that every marked-domain driving process has the same deterministic constant variance κ and drift b, in its capacity chart. Under locality (L6), a deletion with initial derivatives $d = h_0'(0)$ and $e = h_0''(0)$ must obey

$$b = \frac{b}{d} + \left(\frac{\kappa}{2} - 3\right)\frac{e}{d^2}. \tag{L9}$$

Choose the two vertical slits in (L7) at x and $-x$ with the same height. Their derivatives have the same $d \in (0, 1)$ and opposite nonzero e. Subtracting their instances of (L9) yields $\kappa = 6$; either equation then gives $b = b/d$, hence $b = 0$. Thus the only constant-characteristic ensemble in this class is SLE_6.

This two-slit computation is a useful check on the signs and constants, but its universality premise is much stronger than physical translation invariance. The current bottleneck is to prove an adequate chart-martingale or characteristic condition from genuinely coarse properties of critical percolation, rather than to manipulate (L6) further.

8 Dilation symmetry and criticality

8.1 Dilation covariance and subsequential limits

Lemma 8.1. *Every family with a fixed affine SLE_6 normalization is covariant under all scalar dilations: $\mathcal{P}_{rD,rp,rq} = r_*\mathcal{P}_{D,p,q}$ for $r > 0$.*

Proof. Dilations commute with the linear part of the normalizer; conjugating by its full affine map gives a Euclidean similarity. Use SLE similarity covariance. □

Lemma 8.2 (The cluster set, not each cluster point, inherits dilations)**.** *Let X be a topological space of ensembles with continuous dilation actions T_r. Suppose $P_\delta \in X$ has exact mesh covariance $T_r P_\delta = P_{r\delta}$ and is relatively compact as $\delta \downarrow 0$. Its cluster set $\mathcal{C}$ satisfies $T_r\mathcal{C} = \mathcal{C}$. If $\mathcal{C} = \{P\}$, then $T_r P = P$ for every $r > 0$.*

Proof. If $P_{\delta_n} \to P$, continuity gives $P_{r\delta_n} = T_r P_{\delta_n} \to T_r P$. Thus $T_r\mathcal{C} \subset \mathcal{C}$; use $T_{1/r}$ for equality. □

For laws indexed by marked domains the action is $(T_r P)_{D,p,q} = r_* P_{r^{-1}D, r^{-1}p, r^{-1}q}$. One must choose a topology in which the actions are continuous; this is not silently supplied by abstract tightness. The distinction is real: on $X = S^1$, take $P_\delta = \exp(i\omega \log \delta)$ and $T_r z = \exp(i\omega \log r) z$, $\omega \neq 0$. The cluster set is all of S^1 but has no member fixed by every dilation. Uniform nondegenerate observable bounds do not remove this possibility: $\frac{1}{2} + \varepsilon \sin(\omega \log(R/\delta))$, $0 < \varepsilon < 1/2$, remains uniformly bounded while oscillating in scale phase. This is a topological example, not a percolation counterexample. It nevertheless explains why deriving dilation invariance of every subsequential limit from tightness or RSW alone would be circular.

8.2 All-scale RSW and a nonzero near-critical parameter

Proposition 8.3 (A finite correlation scale conflicts with all-scale RSW)**.** *Suppose continuum colorings P^λ obey $T_r P^\lambda = P^{r^{-\alpha}\lambda}$ for some $\alpha > 0$. For a fixed rectangle shape let $c(\lambda)$ be its unit-scale white crossing probability. Assume $c(\lambda) \to 1$ as $\lambda \to +\infty$ and $c(\lambda) \to 0$ as $\lambda \to -\infty$. If one P^λ has white crossing probabilities in $[\varepsilon, 1-\varepsilon]$ at every scale $R > 0$, with fixed $\varepsilon > 0$, then $\lambda = 0$.*

Proof. Scaling a size-R rectangle down to unit size changes the parameter to $R^\alpha \lambda$. Its crossing probability is $c(R^\alpha \lambda)$, which tends to 1 or 0 for positive or negative λ. □

This is a conditional calculation, separate from existence and regularity of near-critical continuum percolation. For standard triangular-lattice near-critical percolation $\alpha = 3/4$. RSW merely on each bounded scale range, with constants depending on that range, does not exclude nonzero mass. Moreover the target-tangent construction has bounded anisotropy and no preferred scale; removing a near-critical parameter does not address the target-consistency obstruction.

9 Near-critical obstruction: what is rigorous and what is not yet transferred

The missing criticality assumption is a separate obstruction from terminal germ dependence. On triangular mesh η, write

$$r(\eta) = \frac{\eta^2}{\alpha_4^\eta(\eta, 1)}, \qquad p_\eta = \frac{1}{2} + \lambda r(\eta), \qquad \lambda \neq 0,$$

where α_4 is the critical alternating four-arm probability. The normalization is $r(\eta) = \eta^{3/4+o(1)}$. At every mesh the exploration has exact spatial domain Markov and locality properties for every p_η. These two properties alone cannot express criticality.

Established external facts (not reproved here). Nolin–Werner, *Asymmetry of near-critical percolation interfaces*, JAMS 22 (2009), 797–819, https://arxiv.org/abs/0710.1470, establish subsequential limits of near-critical interfaces and their singularity with respect to ordinary SLE_6. Garban–Pete–Schramm, *The scaling limits of near-critical and dynamical percolation*, JEMS 20

(2018), 1195–1268, https://arxiv.org/abs/1305.5526, construct the configuration-valued near-critical scaling limit and establish its conformal covariance. Their Section 13.2 explicitly distinguishes the measurable trace of an interface from its order as a curve: the latter uniqueness is not proved there. Their Section 11 Markov property concerns change of the near-critical parameter, not the spatial exploration stopping-time property needed here. Thus neither statement may silently be substituted for full convergence of ordered exploration kernels in random slit domains. A 2025 Durham thesis of Léonie Papon, introduction, https://etheses.durham.ac.uk/id/eprint/16026/1/Papon-thesis-v2.pdf, also records ordered near-critical percolation interface uniqueness as a remaining challenge. These observations are limits of the sources checked, not a proof that no later theorem exists.

A simple necessary test for fixed affine SLE. Every fixed affine image of the ordinary SLE ensemble is covariant under all scalar dilations. Indeed, if the linear part of the affine map is L, then $L(rx) = rLx$; the translation part is absorbed by translation covariance. Consequently a genuine failure of dilation covariance excludes *every* fixed affine normalization. Singularity relative to ordinary SLE alone does not have this implication: an anisotropic affine image may also be singular.

Under a physical dilation by $s > 0$, the near-critical parameter changes as

$$s\,\omega^{\lambda} \overset{\text{law}}{=} \omega^{s^{-3/4}\lambda}.$$

The sign of the exponent follows already on the lattice: the original mesh η becomes $s\eta$ while the same occupation probability has effective parameter $\lambda r(\eta)/r(s\eta) \to s^{-3/4}\lambda$. Known nonconstant crossing probabilities as functions of λ therefore witness a macroscopic scale in the configuration law. Transferring this witness to a full domain-indexed curve ensemble requires the ordered-kernel step just identified. This investigation therefore records near-critical interfaces as a *conditional additional counterexample*, not as the proof of the counterexample in the main text.

9.1 An explicit limit-transfer lemma

Here is a precise sufficient condition for the commonly asserted passage of the spatial Markov property to scaling limits. It isolates the missing assumption rather than labeling it automatic.

Let (I_n, D_n, Y_n) denote respectively the explored initial segment, remaining marked domain, and future curve at a stopping time. Suppose these random objects take values in Polish spaces and converge jointly in distribution to (I, D, Y). Let K_n be the future-curve kernels, so

$$\mathbb{E}[f(Y_n) \mid I_n, D_n] = K_n f(D_n).$$

Assume there is a Borel probability kernel K such that, for every bounded continuous f and every sequence $d_n \to d$ with d in a full-law set for D, one has $K_n f(d_n) \to K f(d)$. Then

$$\mathbb{E}[f(Y) \mid I, D] = K f(D).$$

Proof. By a Skorokhod representation the triples may be assumed to converge almost surely. For any bounded continuous test function h of (I, D), the exact finite-n identity gives

$$\mathbb{E}[h(I_n, D_n) f(Y_n)] = \mathbb{E}[h(I_n, D_n) K_n f(D_n)].$$

Bounded convergence and the sequential-kernel hypothesis give the same identity at the limit, with $Kf(D)$ on the right. The monotone class theorem extends the identity to bounded measurable h, and a countable convergence-determining class of f identifies the conditional kernel. □

The decisive hypothesis controls kernels at *random slit domains*; convergence for one deterministic Jordan domain is insufficient. Analogous coupled convergence can transfer locality before first approach to a removed closed set: stop first at positive-distance neighborhoods, where uniform curve convergence leaves the two coupled initial segments identical, then decrease the distance to zero. Exact first-hit stopping needs a separate continuity argument and is not implicit in this observation.

10 Affine identifiability without Jordan boundary regularity

Status and interpretation. The extension proved here uses only standard quasiconformal compactness, prime-end extension for quasiconformal disk maps, Fatou's theorem for bounded analytic functions, and uniqueness of bounded harmonic functions from their almost-everywhere disk boundary values. It removes the Jordan assumption from affine metric identifiability. At completely arbitrary prime ends a conformal image of SLE need not have a Euclidean-continuous endpoint; its law is therefore understood in the prime-end compactification, or as its conformal hull exploration. The result applies in particular whenever the physical curves are continuous, as in the exploration setting of interest. No classification of arbitrary exploration ensembles is asserted.

10.1 A quasiconformal disk map fixing the boundary stays close to the identity

Lemma (proved). For each finite $K \geq 1$ there exists $C(K) < \infty$ such that every orientation-preserving K-quasiconformal self-homeomorphism $h : \mathbb{D} \to \mathbb{D}$ whose boundary extension fixes every point of $\partial\mathbb{D}$ satisfies

$$d_{\mathbb{D}}(h(z), z) \leq C(K) \qquad (z \in \mathbb{D}). \tag{RA1}$$

Here $d_{\mathbb{D}}$ is hyperbolic distance.

Proof. First there is $r(K) < 1$ with $|h(0)| \leq r(K)$ for all such maps. To see this, extend h to the sphere by reflection in the unit circle:

$$\widetilde{h}(z) = \frac{1}{\overline{h(1/\bar{z})}} \quad (|z| > 1).$$

This is a K-quasiconformal sphere map, and fixes three prescribed distinct points of the unit circle. The standard compactness theorem for normalized K-quasiconformal sphere maps, including compactness of their inverses, precludes a sequence with $h_n(0) \to \zeta \in \partial\mathbb{D}$: a limiting quasiconformal homeomorphism would send both 0 and the fixed boundary point ζ to ζ. Thus such an $r(K)$ exists. For an arbitrary z choose a disk automorphism a_z sending z to 0. The map $a_z \circ h \circ a_z^{-1}$ is again K-quasiconformal with identity boundary map, so

$$|a_z(h(z))| \leq r(K).$$

Conformal invariance of the hyperbolic metric gives (RA1), for example with $C(K) = 2 \operatorname{arctanh} r(K)$ in the usual normalization. □

Consequence (proved). For every $\zeta \in \partial\mathbb{D}$, the image of the radial approach $r\zeta$ under h is a nontangential approach to the same ζ, with aperture bounded solely in terms of K. Indeed rotate so $\zeta = 1$ and write

$$h(r) = \frac{r + u_r}{1 + r u_r}, \qquad |u_r| \leq r(K).$$

Then

$$|1 - h(r)| \le (1 - r)\frac{1 + r(K)}{1 - r(K)},$$

while

$$1 - |h(r)| \ge \frac{1 - r}{2}\frac{1 - r(K)}{1 + r(K)}.$$

The ratio $|1 - h(r)|/(1 - |h(r)|)$ is therefore uniformly bounded. In particular $h(r\zeta) \to \zeta$ within a fixed Stolz region.

10.2 The identifiability theorem on any bounded simply connected domain

Theorem (proved). Let D be any bounded simply connected planar domain and let p, q be distinct prime ends. For orientation-preserving invertible real-linear maps A, B, define

$$\nu^A_{D,p,q} = (A^{-1})_* \,\mathrm{Law}(\mathrm{SLE}_6(AD; Ap, Aq)).$$

Then

$$\nu^A_{D,p,q} = \nu^B_{D,p,q} \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad BA^{-1} \text{ is a Euclidean similarity} \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad B^{\mathsf{T}}B = cA^{\mathsf{T}}A \quad (c > 0). \tag{RA2}$$

The statement holds for exploration laws in the prime-end compactification, and hence for their physical curves whenever defined continuously.

Proof. Set $M = BA^{-1} : AD \to BD$. This bilipschitz map carries null crosscut chains to null crosscut chains, with equivalent chains remaining equivalent; thus it induces the natural homeomorphism of prime-end compactifications. Choose conformal charts $\phi_A : AD \to \mathbb{H}$ and $\phi_B : BD \to \mathbb{H}$ sending the corresponding source and target to $0, \infty$. The interior map

$$H = \phi_B \circ M \circ \phi_A^{-1} : \mathbb{H} \to \mathbb{H}$$

is quasiconformal with a boundary extension to $\mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\}$, fixing $0, \infty$. The boundary map is increasing. The boundary-swallowing race of the main record remains a prime-end topological event: an affine homeomorphism preserves the order in which boundary ends are cut off from the target by the explored filled hull. Equality of the two path laws, followed by strictness of that race probability, therefore gives, for every $x < 0 < y$,

$$\frac{-H(x)}{H(y) - H(x)} = \frac{-x}{y - x}.$$

Consequently $H(x) = cx$ on the entire extended real boundary, for some $c > 0$. This step uses prime-end boundary values of H, not Euclidean boundary values of either Riemann map.

Pass to disk charts, absorbing the conformal map $z \mapsto cz$ into the second chart. We obtain bounded conformal maps

$$\psi_A : \mathbb{D} \to AD, \qquad \psi_B : \mathbb{D} \to BD$$

such that

$$h = \psi_B^{-1} \circ M \circ \psi_A$$

is a K-quasiconformal disk self-homeomorphism with identity boundary map. Thus pointwise in the disk,

$$M\psi_A = \psi_B \circ h. \tag{RA3}$$

Fatou's theorem gives radial limits $\psi_A^*(\zeta)$ and nontangential limits $\psi_B^*(\zeta)$ for almost every circle point ζ. The preceding lemma shows that $h(r\zeta)$ approaches that same ζ nontangentially. Taking $r \uparrow 1$ in (RA3) yields

$$M\psi_A^*(\zeta) = \psi_B^*(\zeta) \quad \text{for almost every } \zeta \in \partial\mathbb{D}. \tag{RA4}$$

Both real coordinates of $M\psi_A$ are bounded harmonic functions on the disk, since M is real-linear and ψ_A is bounded analytic. The coordinates of ψ_B are also bounded harmonic. Uniqueness of the Poisson representation for bounded harmonic functions now gives

$$M\psi_A = \psi_B \qquad \text{throughout } \mathbb{D}.$$

Thus M is conformal on the nonempty open set AD. Writing $M(z) = \alpha z + \beta\bar{z}$, holomorphicity of $M\psi_A$ gives $\beta\overline{\psi_A'(z)} = 0$. Since ψ_A' never vanishes, $\beta = 0$. Invertibility and orientation imply that M is a direct Euclidean similarity. The converse is SLE similarity covariance. Reflections reduce orientation-reversing normalizers to this case. □

The boundedness assumption was used exactly when invoking bounded analytic Fatou limits and bounded harmonic uniqueness. No assertion about arbitrary unbounded domains follows without a growth or uniqueness condition.

10.3 A necessary and sufficient DMP condition inside the affine ansatz

Suppose, as an explicit additional ansatz, that an ensemble has the form

$$P_{D,p,q} = \nu_{D,p,q}^{A(D,p,q)} \tag{RA5}$$

for a deterministic measurable affine label on each marked bounded simply connected domain. Remove the inessential positive scalar from its metric by putting

$$T(D,p,q) = \frac{A(D,p,q)^{\mathsf{T}} A(D,p,q)}{\sqrt{\det(A(D,p,q)^{\mathsf{T}} A(D,p,q))}}. \tag{RA6}$$

Thus T is a positive-definite symmetric matrix of determinant one. Assume the usual Borel family and strong conditional-kernel formulation, so that equality of conditional path laws at a stopping time is an equality of probability kernels almost surely.

Corollary (proved). Within ansatz (RA5), the strong domain Markov property holds if and only if, for every starting marked domain and every admissible stopping time τ,

$$T(D_\tau, p_\tau, q) = T(D,p,q) \qquad \text{almost surely.} \tag{RA7}$$

Here D_τ is the target component of the remaining domain. It need not have Jordan boundary.

Proof. Fix the starting label $A = A(D,p,q)$. Under the fixed-A affine SLE law, ordinary SLE's strong domain Markov property gives, conditional on the explored initial segment, the remaining law

$$\nu_{D_\tau,p_\tau,q}^{A}.$$

Strong DMP for (RA5) demands that this be $\nu_{D_\tau,p_\tau,q}^{A(D_\tau,p_\tau,q)}$ almost surely. The rough-domain theorem (RA2), applied at each realized slit domain, is equivalent to equality of their normalized metric tensors, namely (RA7). Conversely (RA7) and similarity covariance identify these two conditional laws, proving strong DMP. □

This corollary classifies the DMP constraint only *within the stated ansatz*: the affine tensor must be a conserved quantity of the exploration state. A target-germ tensor supplies exactly such a conserved quantity. The corollary neither proves that a general ensemble has affine-SLE form nor that every conserved tensor must arise from a target germ. Locality, translation covariance, target consistency, and boundary continuity impose further constraints which are not characterized by (RA7) alone.

11 Local target consistency passes to marginal curve limits

Scope. This lemma transfers an exploration coupling only inside a fixed neighborhood of the common start. It needs convergence of the two marginal curve laws, but neither convergence of random slit-domain kernels nor a limiting strong domain Markov theorem. It does not assert a coupling of the limiting curves all the way to a distant boundary arc.

11.1 Stopping an ordered unparameterized curve on a circle

Fix $p \in \mathbb{R}^2$ and $R_0 > 0$. Work in the usual metric space of oriented continuous curves modulo increasing reparameterization, with the uniform Fréchet topology. Curves start at p and end outside $\overline{B(p, R_0)}$. Small changes of the starting points are harmless; for the sequence version they need only lie inside every fixed smaller ball for sufficiently large indices. For a continuous representative $\gamma : [0, 1] \to \mathbb{R}^2$ and $0 < r < R_0$, put

$$\tau_\gamma(r) = \inf\{t : |\gamma(t) - p| \geq r\}, \qquad E_r\gamma = \gamma|_{[0,\tau_\gamma(r)]}. \tag{LT1}$$

The stopped path is regarded as an ordered unparameterized curve, so this definition is independent of pauses or changes of clock.

Lemma 11.1 (Almost every circle is a continuity circle)**.** *For each fixed continuous curve γ, the map $(\eta, s) \mapsto E_s\eta$ is continuous at (γ, r) for all but at most countably many radii $r \in (0, R_0)$. The stopping map is Borel. Consequently, for any probability law μ on these curves, E_r is μ-almost surely continuous for Lebesgue-almost every deterministic r.*

Proof. Choose any continuous representative of γ. The function $r \mapsto \tau_\gamma(r)$ is nondecreasing and hence has at most countably many discontinuities. Suppose it is continuous at r. If $(\gamma_n, r_n) \to (\gamma, r)$ in the product of Fréchet and ordinary metrics, choose increasing reparameterizations for which representatives $\widetilde{\gamma}_n$ converge uniformly to γ. Writing $\varepsilon_n = \|\widetilde{\gamma}_n - \gamma\|_\infty + |r_n - r|$, first-hit times obey, for every slightly larger positive error tending to zero,

$$\tau_\gamma(r - 2\varepsilon_n) \;\leq\; \tau_{\widetilde{\gamma}_n}(r_n) \;\leq\; \tau_\gamma(r + 2\varepsilon_n). \tag{LT2}$$

If $\varepsilon_n = 0$ the assertion is immediate; using a strictly larger error avoids any immaterial equality convention. Continuity of τ_γ at r gives convergence of the middle times to $\tau_\gamma(r)$. Uniform continuity of γ then makes the stopped representatives, linearly recoded onto $[0, 1]$, converge uniformly. This proves joint continuity at (γ, r).

The stopping map is understood on all curves reaching the selected radius, including already stopped curves reaching a larger radius. For parameterized curves the stopping time is Borel, since

$$\{\tau_\gamma(r) \leq t\} = \left\{ \max_{0 \leq u \leq t} |\gamma(u) - p| \geq r \right\}.$$

Stopping and linear recoding are therefore Borel path operations. They commute with reparameterization and give the usual Borel stopping map on ordered unparameterized curves.

For completeness, the almost-every-radius assertion does not require a measurable choice of representatives. For a map between metric spaces its set of continuity points is a G_δ set, obtained from its oscillations on neighborhoods. Apply this to the joint stopping map. Its discontinuity set in the product of curve space and radius space is Borel, and every vertical section has Lebesgue measure zero by the countability argument above. Fubini's theorem now gives the assertion under μ. □

Why a bad radius can occur. A path may first touch a circle, then spend a nontrivial segment inside it, and only later cross it. A small outward perturbation can postpone its first exit until that later crossing. This is why stopping continuity cannot simply be claimed at every deterministic radius for every path. The preceding lemma handles these tangencies without excluding them by an unproved regularity assumption.

11.2 Transfer using only two marginal limits

Theorem 11.2 (Transfer of local target consistency)**.** *For $i = 1, 2$, let γ_n^i be oriented continuous random curves whose marginal laws converge weakly in the uniform Fréchet topology to laws μ^i. Assume the limiting curves start at p and end outside $\overline{B(p, R_0)}$. Suppose that for every fixed $r \in (0, R_0)$ and all sufficiently large n,*

$$\mathrm{Law}(E_r\gamma_n^1) = \mathrm{Law}(E_r\gamma_n^2). \tag{LT3}$$

Then the same equality holds for the limiting curves at every *$r \in (0, R_0)$:*

$$(E_r)_*\mu^1 = (E_r)_*\mu^2. \tag{LT4}$$

The hypothesis (LT3) may equivalently be replaced by a discrepancy tending to zero in any metric inducing weak convergence of the stopped laws.

Proof. Lemma 11.1 gives a full-Lebesgue-measure set of radii at which E_r is almost surely continuous under both limiting laws. At each such radius the continuous mapping theorem and (LT3) give (LT4). This part needs no joint convergence of (γ_n^1, γ_n^2).

To obtain every smaller radius, fix arbitrary $r < R_0$ and choose a good $s \in (r, R_0)$. Equality of the stopped-at-s laws remains equality after applying the Borel map E_r. Since $E_r(E_s\gamma) = E_r\gamma$ for $r < s$, this proves (LT4) at r without requiring any continuity of E_r there. □

11.3 Application to two percolation targets

Let D be a Jordan domain, p a common boundary start, and let the targets q_1, q_2 lie on a boundary arc J with $p \notin \overline{J}$. The boundary colors for the two Dobrushin explorations differ only on the arc between the targets. Use identical independent bulk colors and identical boundary colors outside a lattice approximation J_n of this disagreement arc, with a common discrete starting edge. The discrete exploration rules produce exactly the same ordered initial path until the exploration first encounters J_n. Choose

$$0 < R_0 < \mathrm{dist}(p, \overline{J}).$$

For all large n, the approximating disagreement arc stays outside the closed ball $\overline{B(p, R_0)}$. Thus (LT3) holds inside every smaller ball. If a common subsequence makes each marginal exploration

converge, Theorem 11.2 supplies local target consistency for their limiting initial segments. The lattice approximations must in fact have the stated common-start/common-color coupling; a small displacement of two unrelated explorations alone would not justify pathwise closeness.

Consequence for affine decorations. The affine-metric elimination argument needs only equality of these local prefix laws, not equality until the full distant arc. Suppose D is analytic near p and the two limiting marginals have laws

$$(A_i^{-1})_* \operatorname{SLE}_6(A_i D, A_i p, A_i q_i), \qquad i = 1, 2.$$

Translate p to zero and blow up space. By conformal kernel convergence at the smooth start, the local initial laws tend to

$$(A_i^{-1})_* \operatorname{SLE}_6(A_i H_p, 0, \infty),$$

where H_p is the tangent half-plane. Equality in every sufficiently small physical ball transfers after dilation to equality of the limiting stopped laws in every fixed half-disk (first at common continuity radii, then all smaller radii by the same composition argument). These local restrictions determine the entire half-plane law. Strict left-passage identifiability therefore makes $A_2 A_1^{-1}$ a similarity.

Consequently the target-tangent affine counterexample cannot be the family of simultaneous two-target subsequential percolation limits on a fixed smooth domain with targets carrying different tangent directions. This exclusion is independent of the more difficult transfer of a strong domain Markov property to random limiting slit domains.

12 Affine metrics encoded in initial path germs

Status and motivation. The result below is proved for the *oriented initial trace germ* of an affine image of half-plane SLE_6 at its smooth starting boundary point. It does not construct a source-dependent domain Markov family. In particular, it does not establish that the metric can be recovered from the unlabelled boundary germ at a later random exploration tip. Those distinctions are important when assessing whether target consistency alone could repair the classification conjecture.

12.1 State space and the meaning of a trace germ

We retain the chronological order of a path but forget its original clock. For the half-plane curves used here, the usual half-plane-capacity clock provides a canonical representative: the filled hull at time t has hydrodynamic map $g_t(z) = z + 2t/z + o(1/z)$. This clock is determined by the ordered unparameterized trace. Section 3.3 justifies continuous Loewner driving of affine images; hence they admit this clock. The clock has infinite total lifetime almost surely: its total half-plane capacity T is positive, while spatial scale invariance makes its law equal to that of $r^2 T$ for every $r > 0$; the only such probability laws on $[0, \infty]$ are supported on $\{0, \infty\}$. Thus $T = \infty$. All functions below are functions of the ordered unparameterized trace.

Use the standard Borel space of these capacity-parameterized continuous curves, with the sigma-field generated by restrictions to finite time intervals. Equivalently, this can be regarded as a Borel realization of the usual ordered unparameterized path space. For $t > 0$, let

$$\mathcal{F}_t = \sigma\{\gamma(s) : 0 \le s \le t\}, \qquad \mathcal{F}_{0+} = \bigcap_{t>0} \mathcal{F}_t.$$

The latter is the initial trace-germ sigma-field. It is unaffected by changing any part of the curve after a positive capacity time. The canonical time is used only to give an explicit measurable coding of this germ.

For $r > 0$, let $S_r\gamma$ be the spatially dilated trace, again put in the canonical clock. Capacity scaling gives the exact identity

$$(S_r\gamma)(t) = r\gamma(t/r^2). \tag{SG1}$$

In particular S_r is invertible with inverse $S_{1/r}$.

12.2 Dilation ergodicity

Lemma 12.1 (Brownian scaling is mixing)**.** *For a one-sided Brownian motion $B = (B_t)_{t\geq 0}$ and any fixed $r > 1$, the measure-preserving transformation*

$$(\mathcal{S}_r B)_t = r B_{t/r^2}$$

is mixing and hence ergodic.

Proof. Set $Z_s = e^{-s/2}B_{e^s}$ for $s \in \mathbb{R}$. This is a stationary centered Gaussian process with

$$\mathbb{E}[Z_s Z_u] = e^{-|s-u|/2}.$$

It is the stationary Ornstein–Uhlenbeck process. Under $\mathcal{S}_r$, it becomes $Z_{s-2\log r}$. Covariances between finite collections of coordinates separated by $n(2\log r)$ tend to zero, so the corresponding jointly Gaussian vectors become independent in the limit. Approximation by finite-coordinate cylinder functions gives mixing on the full path sigma-field. The correspondence is invertible almost surely: $B_t = \sqrt{t}\, Z_{\log t}$ for $t > 0$, with $B_0 = 0$. Thus mixing transfers back to Brownian scaling. The two-sided log-time process here is obtained from a one-sided Brownian path at times $t > 0$; no independent Brownian past is being added. □

Lemma 12.2 (Affine SLE_6 is dilation mixing)**.** *Let A be any invertible linear map carrying $\mathbb{H}$ onto itself and fixing its positive boundary orientation. Define*

$$\mu_A = \mathrm{Law}(A^{-1}\eta), \qquad \eta \sim \mathrm{SLE}_6(\mathbb{H}, 0, \infty),$$

with the physical half-plane-capacity representative understood. For every fixed $r > 1$, S_r preserves μ_A and is mixing under μ_A.

Proof. The SLE trace is a measurable, scaling-equivariant function of its Brownian Loewner driver $\sqrt{6}B$. The trace exists almost surely. Therefore its dilation action is a factor of the Brownian scaling action and is mixing by Lemma 12.1. The map on ordered traces $\eta \mapsto A^{-1}\eta$ commutes with scalar spatial dilations, and is an invertible measurable map after recoding by capacity. Mixing and invariance therefore transfer to μ_A. □

12.3 Separating distinct metrics from arbitrarily short initial segments

Normalize the maps preserving $\mathbb{H}$ by

$$A_{b,c} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & b \\ 0 & c \end{pmatrix}, \qquad b \in \mathbb{R},\ c > 0. \tag{SG2}$$

This parametrizes all constant positive-definite conformal metrics, up to a positive scalar, in a fixed half-plane frame: the tensor is $A_{b,c}^{\mathsf{T}} A_{b,c}$ with its $(1,1)$ entry normalized to 1. The laws $\mu_{A_{b,c}}$ are distinct. Indeed, the strictly increasing SLE_6 left-passage function F gives

$$\mu_{A_{b,c}}[L(x+iy)] = F\left(\frac{x+by}{cy}\right). \tag{SG3}$$

Equality of the probabilities at $z = i$ and $z = 1 + i$ first identifies b/c and then $1/c$, hence both parameters.

Lemma 12.3 (Unit-time restrictions distinguish the metrics)**.** *If $A \neq A'$ are two normalized maps in (SG2), the laws of their traces restricted to capacity time $[0,1]$ are distinct.*

Proof. If the restrictions agreed, dilation invariance and (SG1) would make the restrictions to $[0,T]$ agree for every $T > 0$. Those restrictions generate the full path sigma-field, so the entire laws would agree, contrary to (SG3). □

Theorem 12.4 (Metric decoding from an initial trace germ)**.** *Let $\{A_j : j \in J\}$ be any finite or countable collection of distinct normalized maps (SG2). There exists an $\mathcal{F}_{0+}$-measurable function D with values in $J \cup \{\dagger\}$ such that*

$$\mu_{A_j}[D(\gamma) = j] = 1 \qquad \text{for every } j \in J. \tag{SG4}$$

In particular, restrictions of these affine SLE_6 measures to the initial trace-germ sigma-field are mutually singular, even though each separately has its usual almost-sure germ zero-one property.

Proof. For each pair $j \neq k$, Lemma 12.3 supplies a Borel set of unit-time traces whose indicator f_{jk} has distinct expectations under μ_{A_j} and μ_{A_k}. There are only countably many such pairs; list all the resulting bounded unit-time observables as $(f_m)_{m\geq 1}$. Write $v_{j,m} = \int f_m \, d\mu_{A_j}$. The vectors $v_j = (v_{j,m})_m$ are pairwise distinct.

Fix $r > 1$. By Lemma 12.2 and Birkhoff's ergodic theorem, for each m and each j,

$$\frac{1}{N}\sum_{n=1}^{N} f_m(S_{r^n}\gamma) \longrightarrow v_{j,m} \qquad \mu_{A_j}\text{-almost surely.} \tag{SG5}$$

The intersection of these events over m still has full μ_{A_j} measure. Every term $f_m(S_{r^n}\gamma)$ depends only on the trace up to time r^{-2n}. For any $t > 0$, all sufficiently late terms are consequently $\mathcal{F}_t$-measurable. Omitting finitely many initial terms does not change a Cesàro limit. Thus every limit in (SG5), and the event that the limit exists, is $\mathcal{F}_{0+}$-measurable.

Define $D = j$ if all limits exist and their vector equals v_j; use $D = \dagger$ otherwise. Countability of J and pairwise distinctness of the v_j make this a measurable unambiguous definition. Formula (SG5) proves (SG4). □

12.4 A common decoder for the continuum of normalized metrics

The countable proof extends to all parameters $(b,c) \in \Theta = \mathbb{R} \times (0,\infty)$, provided the standard path coding is used jointly in the affine parameter. We state this coding point explicitly.

Joint Borel capacity coding. Let η be an ordinary capacity-parameterized SLE_6 trace and K_s its filled hull. Before recoding, its affine image is the continuous path $A_{b,c}^{-1}\eta(s)$. Its physical capacity clock is

$$u_{b,c,\eta}(s) = \tfrac{1}{2}\,\mathrm{hcap}(A_{b,c}^{-1}K_s). \tag{SG6}$$

Use the standard measurable coding of compact half-plane hulls, in which filling a continuous path prefix and taking its half-plane capacity are Borel operations. Linear transformation is jointly continuous on compact sets. Consequently $(b, c, \eta, s) \mapsto u_{b,c,\eta}(s)$ is Borel. The inverse clock is measurable because, on the set where the clock is continuous and strictly increasing,

$$u_{b,c,\eta}^{-1}(t) = \inf\{s : u_{b,c,\eta}(s) > t\}$$

can be computed using rational s (with equality interpreted by continuity). Thus evaluation of the recoded image on $[0, 1]$ is jointly Borel in (b, c, η). The good-clock conditions are Borel using rational tests; on their complement use a cemetery path. For each fixed (b, c) this complement has SLE probability zero by the affine local-growth and lifetime arguments above. No single full-probability set valid simultaneously for all affine parameters is required.

This paragraph uses the usual deterministic measurability of hull capacity as part of the standard Borel curve coding. If that coding fact is not taken as established, the next corollary should be read conditionally on joint Borel recoding. The preceding countable theorem needs only measurable recoding for each of its countably many fixed maps.

Corollary 12.5 (Continuum metric decoder)**.** *With the joint Borel coding just specified, there exists one $\mathcal{F}_{0+}$-measurable map*

$$D_{\mathrm{all}} : \mathcal{C} \longrightarrow \Theta \cup \{\dagger\}$$

such that for every $(b, c) \in \Theta$,

$$\mu_{A_{b,c}}[D_{\mathrm{all}}(\gamma) = (b, c)] = 1. \tag{SG7}$$

The same single measurable rule therefore recovers every normalized affine metric, with almost-sure correctness under each metric law separately.

Proof. Choose a countable generating π-system for the standard Borel space of unit-capacity path segments, including the cemetery state. For example, use finite intersections of rational-time evaluation cylinders in rational rectangles, together with the cemetery singleton. Let $(f_m)_{m\ge1}$ be their indicator functions. They determine probability laws on unit segments. Joint Borel recoding and integration against the fixed ordinary SLE law imply that

$$v : \Theta \to [0, 1]^{\mathbb{N}}, \qquad v_m(b, c) = \int f_m \, d\mu_{A_{b,c}}, \tag{SG8}$$

is Borel. Lemma 12.3 and the determining property of (f_m) imply that v is injective. Both parameter and sequence spaces are standard Borel, so the Lusin–Souslin theorem makes $v(\Theta)$ Borel and $v^{-1} : v(\Theta) \to \Theta$ Borel.

Fix $r > 1$. Form the vector $L(\gamma)$ of Cesàro limits

$$L_m(\gamma) = \lim_{N\to\infty} \frac{1}{N} \sum_{n=1}^{N} f_m(S_{r^n}\gamma),$$

using a cemetery value if any limit fails to exist. The proof of Theorem 12.4 shows that L is $\mathcal{F}_{0+}$-measurable. Define $D_{\mathrm{all}} = v^{-1}(L)$ when $L \in v(\Theta)$ and set it to $\dagger$ otherwise. This is a measurable definition; no measurable selection theorem is needed. For each fixed (b, c), ergodicity and Birkhoff applied to the countable family (f_m) give $L = v(b, c)$ almost surely under $\mu_{A_{b,c}}$. This proves (SG7). □

Quantifiers and limitations. The statement is one common decoder with correctness under each law: $\forall(b,c)\ \mu_{A_{b,c}}(D_{\mathrm{all}} = (b,c)) = 1$. It does not assert one common full-probability set of Brownian seeds on which correctness holds simultaneously after every uncountable collection of affine transformations. More importantly, the decoded object is still an ordered initial trace germ at a smooth start, not the bare boundary germ of a random slit-domain tip.

What has and has not been proved. The theorem demonstrates an exact mechanism by which a microscopic ordered path germ can store a constant affine metric. It is more than identifiability of the law: a single arbitrarily short trace germ distinguishes any prescribed countable collection of metrics almost surely, and the continuum corollary extends this under the stated joint Borel coding. The result does not contradict a germ zero-one law, since that law concerns one probability measure, while the distinguishing full-measure germ sets differ between measures.

A hypothetical source-germ decoration could choose a metric from the smooth initial source geometry, then attempt to recover the same metric from the slit boundary at all later tips. That recovery does *not* follow from Theorem 12.4. Three obstacles remain:

1. A later tip is not a smooth half-plane starting boundary point; the nearby past trace can have a different two-sided or conditioned local law.

2. The remaining marked domain gives an embedded boundary germ, which may lose chronological information when the trace has touched itself. The theorem uses an oriented initial trace germ and does not prove that the needed data are recoverable from that boundary alone.

3. A domain Markov construction would need one measurable rule valid at all relevant stopping times and compatible with locality deletions, not merely a decoder at a deterministic initial point under each fixed metric law.

Extending local metric decoding to random interior or tip germs, or proving that such decoding is impossible from the domain state, is a concrete next research question. No full counterexample satisfying target consistency is claimed from this mechanism.

13 A fixed metric follows inside the affine-SLE ansatz with target consistency and reversal

Status. This theorem assumes that every marginal is already an affine image of SLE_6. It does not derive that ansatz from coarse percolation properties. It shows that quite weak physical coherence conditions then eliminate all variation of the affine conformal structure between domains and marked points. Geometric reversal is an explicit additional hypothesis; it is not asserted here to follow from RSW or from the original three axioms.

Let $\mathcal{D}$ be the class of bounded Jordan domains whose boundaries consist of finitely many regular real-analytic arcs meeting at corners. Each analytic arc extends to a neighborhood of its closed parameter interval. Restrict marks to regular boundary points, meaning interior points of these arcs. Suppose

$$P_{D,p,q} = (A_{D,p,q}^{-1})_* \,\mathrm{SLE}_6(A_{D,p,q}D, A_{D,p,q}p, A_{D,p,q}q), \tag{AA1}$$

where $A_{D,p,q}$ is an invertible orientation-preserving linear map. Write $[Q_{D,p,q}]$ for the projective positive-definite tensor $[A_{D,p,q}^{\mathsf{T}} A_{D,p,q}]$; brackets identify positive scalar multiples.

The following elementary local identifiability principle will be used: if two laws of the form (AA1), on domains agreeing near the same regular start, have identical initial paths stopped in

every sufficiently small ball, then their projective tensors are equal. Indeed blow up at the regular start. Conformal kernel convergence for ordinary SLE gives half-plane limits $A_i^{-1}\,\mathrm{SLE}_6(A_iH,0,\infty)$. Equality of local prefixes gives equality of these half-plane laws; the strictly monotone SLE_6 left-passage function makes $A_2A_1^{-1}$ a similarity. This argument uses only local SLE convergence and the affine ansatz.

Theorem 13.1 (Conditional global metric rigidity)**.** *Assume (AA1), together with the following properties on $\mathcal{D}$:*

1. Translation covariance.
2. Locality for nested domains*: if $D' \subset D$ agrees with D near regular marks p, q, the two initial laws agree until they encounter the removed set.*
3. Local target consistency*: for fixed D, p and any two regular targets q_1, q_2, the two initial laws agree when stopped on every sufficiently small circle centered at p.*
4. Geometric reversibility*: reversing an ordered path with law $P_{D,p,q}$ gives law $P_{D,q,p}$.*

Then there is one fixed positive-definite tensor Q_0, up to scalar, with $[Q_{D,p,q}] = [Q_0]$ for every admissible triple. Equivalently, one fixed linear map transforms the entire family into ordinary chordal SLE_6. No domain Markov hypothesis is needed for this conditional conclusion.

Proof. First, remove dependence on marks inside one domain. Fix D and a regular start p. Local target consistency and local identifiability make $[Q_{D,p,q}]$ independent of q. Ordinary SLE_6 is geometrically reversible by [3]. Therefore reversal of (AA1) retains its same tensor, and the assumed reversal of P implies

$$[Q_{D,p,q}] = [Q_{D,q,p}].$$

Given regular p, p', choose a third regular point q. Changing the target with fixed start q and reversing at the two ends shows

$$[Q_{D,p,q}] = [Q_{D,q,p}] = [Q_{D,q,p'}] = [Q_{D,p',q}].$$

Thus there is a tensor $[Q(D)]$ independent of both marks.

Second, compare nested domains with retained regular boundary arcs. If $D' \subset D$ agrees with D near two distinct regular boundary points, choose them as p, q. Locality makes the initial laws agree in some ball about p, and local identifiability gives $[Q(D')] = [Q(D)]$. The removed set may meet other parts of the boundary; it stays a positive distance from the selected marks.

Third, create a horizontal boundary segment without changing the metric. For any $D \in \mathcal{D}$, choose a horizontal line $\{y = c\}$ with $\min_{\partial D} \operatorname{Im} z < c < \max_{\partial D} \operatorname{Im} z$, at a regular value of the boundary height and not through a corner, and intersect D with $\{y > c\}$. Such a regular value with nonempty intersection exists: on each nonhorizontal analytic boundary arc the critical points are isolated, and horizontal arcs contribute only finitely many excluded height values. Choose the level also away from all corner heights. The analytic arcs are understood to extend regularly to neighborhoods of their closed parameter intervals, so there are only finitely many critical points unless an arc is horizontal. There are finitely many transverse crossings, and a component U of the intersection is again a piecewise real-analytic Jordan domain. It contains an original analytic boundary arc above the cutting line and also an open horizontal segment of the cutting line on its boundary. Choose two regular marks on the retained original arc. The second step gives $[Q(U)] = [Q(D)]$.

Choose a sufficiently short subsegment of the horizontal boundary segment. An upper half-disk V on that diameter lies in U, agrees with U near two distinct interior diameter points, and belongs to $\mathcal{D}$. The second step again gives $[Q(V)] = [Q(U)]$.

Finally, compare all horizontal upper half-disks. Translation covariance identifies their tensors for equal radii and arbitrary centers. Two upper half-disks with the same center and radii $r < R$ are nested and agree near any two distinct points on the smaller open diameter. The second step makes their tensors equal. Thus all such half-disks have one tensor $[Q_0]$, and the third step shows $[Q(D)] = [Q_0]$ for every D.

Choose a fixed A_0 with $A_0^{\mathsf{T}} A_0 = Q_0$. Equality of projective tensors gives $A_{D,p,q} = c_{D,p,q} R_{D,p,q} A_0$ with $c_{D,p,q} > 0$ and $R_{D,p,q}$ orthogonal. Similarity covariance of SLE_6 in (AA1) removes those extra factors, leaving exactly $(A_0^{-1})_* \,\mathrm{SLE}_6(A_0 D, A_0 p, A_0 q)$. □

Boundary regularity in the cutting step. A transverse horizontal cut of a piecewise real-analytic Jordan domain has finitely many intersections with its boundary. Each component is simply connected: a Jordan loop in the intersection has its interior in both the original Jordan domain and the upper half-plane. Its boundary consists of finitely many original arcs and cutting-line segments meeting at transverse corners, so the component is Jordan with piecewise real-analytic boundary. At least one retained original arc and one cutting segment occur in every nontrivial component chosen in the proof. This also makes all marked-point comparisons legitimate within the stated class.

Use for the percolation program. Local target consistency can be transferred from common-color discrete couplings to simultaneous marginal curve limits without random-domain kernel convergence, as established separately. Reversibility is a further assumption. For a general lattice model with critical density different from 1/2, reversing the color-oriented exploration is not automatically the same as swapping its start and target in a fixed convention: it also changes which boundary arc has each color. No exact discrete color symmetry, nor limiting reversal theorem, is supplied by the present argument. The main unsolved analytic step remains establishing (AA1), or an alternative local structure theorem, from the original axioms plus appropriate coherence.

14 Continuous affine labels: deterministic support and source independence

Status. The result here is conditional on the deterministic affine-SLE ansatz and an explicit continuity condition on its metric labels. It does not apply to a general exploration ensemble. It gives a further restriction inside that ansatz: a continuous conserved label cannot encode information in the source prime end. Source independence alone gives no target or domain independence; the final corollary adds explicit target-consistency and locality hypotheses to obtain a global metric.

14.1 The precise continuity premise

Let $T(D, p, q)$ be the determinant-one conformal metric tensor of the affine label, as in (RA6), on all bounded simply connected domains with two distinct prime ends. We use the following sufficient premise, stated in a form that is stable under the fixed affine change of coordinates needed for each starting law.

Affine-stable marked-chart continuity. For every fixed invertible real-linear map L, suppose $f_n : \mathbb{H} \to E_n$ are conformal maps onto bounded simply connected domains, with a nondegenerate

conformal limit $f_n \to f : \mathbb{H} \to E$ locally uniformly in $\mathbb{H}$. The marked prime ends are $f_n(0), f_n(\infty)$ and $f(0), f(\infty)$, respectively; these are prime-end extensions, whether or not they have Euclidean point limits. Require

$$T(LE_n, Lf_n(0), Lf_n(\infty)) \longrightarrow T(LE, Lf(0), Lf(\infty)). \tag{SS1}$$

Thus the topology is locally uniform convergence of inverse conformal charts with the two designated boundary preimages $0, \infty$, and the premise also applies after each fixed affine map. This is an explicit additional hypothesis; it is not inferred merely from DMP, locality, or physical translation invariance. An equivalent affine-stable marked kernel notion may be used instead, provided it supplies (SS1).

Why fixed affine maps preserve this marked topology (proved using standard Beltrami stability). In fact the displayed premise for all L follows from its case $L = I$. Here is the needed topological fact. Write an orientation-preserving real-linear map as $L(z) = \alpha z + \beta \bar{z}$, with $|\beta/\alpha| < 1$. The Beltrami coefficients of $L \circ f_n$ are

$$\mu_n(z) = \frac{\beta}{\alpha} \frac{\overline{f_n'(z)}}{f_n'(z)}.$$

Since the nonvanishing derivatives f_n' converge locally uniformly to f', these coefficients converge pointwise in $\mathbb{H}$ to the analogous μ, all with the same bound $k < 1$. Extend them to the lower half-plane by reflection, $\mu_n(\bar{z}) = \overline{\mu_n(z)}$. Let h_n be the normalized quasiconformal sphere solutions fixing $0, 1, \infty$. The standard stability theorem for the measurable Riemann mapping theorem (uniform bound $k < 1$ and almost-everywhere convergence of coefficients) gives locally uniform convergence of h_n and their inverses to h and h^{-1}. Reflection symmetry and normalized uniqueness imply that every h_n maps $\mathbb{H}$ onto itself and fixes the two marked boundary points $0, \infty$.

The maps

$$\chi_n = L \circ f_n \circ h_n^{-1} : \mathbb{H} \longrightarrow LE_n$$

are conformal by Beltrami factorization. They converge locally uniformly to the nondegenerate conformal map $\chi = L \circ f \circ h^{-1}$, and their marked endpoints are precisely $Lf_n(0), Lf_n(\infty)$. This proves continuity of a fixed orientation- preserving affine change of the physical domains in the marked conformal- chart topology. A reflection handles the other orientation. Consequently ordinary marked-chart continuity of T implies (SS1). Keeping (SS1) explicit in the proof below makes clear that its charts are holomorphic in the affine SLE coordinates, even when their physical pullbacks are only quasiconformal. The additional analytical input in this paragraph is the standard normalized Beltrami stability theorem; no claim about Euclidean uniform boundary convergence is needed.

14.2 Full support transfers conservation to deterministic Loewner controls

Fix a starting label $A = A(D, p, q)$ and a conformal map $f : \mathbb{H} \to AD$ with $f(0) = Ap$, $f(\infty) = Aq$. For any continuous real function w on $[0, t]$ with $w(0) = 0$, let g_t^w denote the associated hydrodynamic Loewner map on its surviving half-plane domain. Define the marked target state by the inverse conformal chart

$$f_t^w(z) = f\big((g_t^w)^{-1}(z + w(t))\big), \qquad z \in \mathbb{H}. \tag{SS2}$$

This state is a simply connected domain with two designated prime ends for *every* continuous w. The assertion does not say that every such w generates a trace. No trace is needed to define the

domain state in (SS2). For the Brownian driving paths of SLE the state is its actual remaining target domain.

The map $w \mapsto f_t^w$ is continuous from the uniform norm on $C[0,t]$ to locally uniform convergence of conformal maps on $\mathbb{H}$. For example, the inverse map can be represented by the reverse ODE

$$\dot{v}_s = -\frac{2}{v_s - w(t-s)}, \quad v_0 = z, \quad (g_t^w)^{-1}(z) = v_t. \tag{SS3}$$

Its imaginary part is nondecreasing. On a compact set with $\operatorname{Im} z \geq \delta > 0$, denominators stay away from zero and the usual ODE stability estimate gives locally uniform continuity in w. Translations by $w(t)$ and composition with f preserve this continuity. The corresponding metric functional

$$\mathcal{T}_t(w) = T\big(A^{-1} f_t^w(\mathbb{H}), A^{-1} f_t^w(0), A^{-1} f_t^w(\infty)\big) \tag{SS4}$$

is therefore continuous by (SS1), with $L = A^{-1}$.

Deterministic-support lemma (proved). If the affine-label ensemble has strong DMP and satisfies (SS1), then for every $t > 0$ and every continuous control $w \in C[0,t]$ with $w(0) = 0$,

$$\mathcal{T}_t(w) = T(D, p, q). \tag{SS5}$$

For the source-independence conclusion below it suffices to apply this to smooth linear ramps.

Proof. Under the original affine SLE law the driving process in AD is $\sqrt{6}B$. The DMP conservation criterion (RA7) gives $\mathcal{T}_t(\sqrt{6}B) = T(D, p, q)$ almost surely. Brownian measure has full support on the space of continuous functions starting at zero in the uniform topology. If (SS5) failed at one control w, continuity of $\mathcal{T}_t$ would give an open uniform neighborhood on which it differs from the fixed tensor. Brownian full support gives that neighborhood positive probability, contradicting almost-sure conservation. □

One could avoid defining the functional at non-trace-generating controls by restricting the statement to controls at which the state functional has a continuous extension, and applying full support there. In particular smooth ramps suffice. The all-prime-end ansatz already makes (SS4) defined on every state, so the formulation above is simpler.

14.3 Rapid driving ramps move the source at vanishing capacity

Theorem (proved, within the stated ansatz). Under strong DMP and (SS1), the tensor $T(D, p, q)$ is independent of the source prime end: for every bounded simply connected D and every three prime ends with $p, p' \neq q$,

$$T(D, p, q) = T(D, p', q). \tag{SS6}$$

It may still depend on the target or on the domain; these are unresolved by this argument.

Proof. Use the notation above and write $Ap' = f(a)$ for the unique finite $a \in \mathbb{R}$ corresponding to the new source. Choose $t_n \downarrow 0$ and use the smooth control

$$w_n(s) = \frac{as}{t_n}, \qquad 0 \leq s \leq t_n.$$

The deterministic-support lemma says that every resulting metric equals $T(D, p, q)$. From the reverse equation (SS3),

$$|(g_{t_n}^{w_n})^{-1}(z) - z| \leq \frac{2t_n}{\operatorname{Im} z}. \tag{SS7}$$

Consequently, locally uniformly in $\mathbb{H}$,

$$f_{t_n}^{w_n}(z) = f\big((g_{t_n}^{w_n})^{-1}(z+a)\big) \longrightarrow f(z+a).$$

The limiting chart has image AD, source $f(a) = Ap'$, and the same target $f(\infty) = Aq$. Applying (SS1) with $L = A^{-1}$ gives (SS6). □

The controls may have very large slopes as $t_n \to 0$; this is harmless. Each fixed ramp lies in the support of Brownian driving on its own finite interval. The argument uses the possibility of rare events, not their uniform probability as $n \to \infty$. The limiting source change is a statement about marked prime-end charts, not Euclidean convergence of a curve of vanishing diameter: the capacity vanishes while the tip may travel far along a thin boundary region.

14.4 A fixed metric in the affine ansatz without a reversal hypothesis

Corollary (proved, conditional on the global affine ansatz). Suppose the ensemble has a deterministic affine-SLE label on *all* bounded simply connected domains and distinct prime ends, has strong DMP, and its normalized tensor T is continuous for marked inverse-conformal- chart convergence. Suppose in addition that its piecewise real-analytic Jordan subfamily has translation covariance, locality for nested domains retaining neighborhoods of regular marks, and local target consistency in the sense used by the conditional global metric-rigidity theorem. Then there is one fixed determinant-one tensor Q_0 such that

$$T(D, p, q) = Q_0$$

for every bounded simply connected marked domain. No geometric reversal hypothesis is needed for this conditional conclusion.

Proof. The source-independence theorem removes dependence on p. On a regular piecewise real-analytic Jordan domain, local target consistency together with the local half-plane identifiability argument removes dependence on q as well. Thus these domains have a tensor $Q(D)$ independent of both marks. The nested-cut argument in the preceding conditional global metric-rigidity theorem now applies verbatim, without its reversal step: nested locality identifies tensors of domains agreeing near two retained regular marks; a transverse horizontal cut creates a horizontal segment; a small upper half-disk on that segment retains the metric; translation and nesting identify all such half-disks. Hence all piecewise real-analytic Jordan domains have the same tensor Q_0.

To extend to an arbitrary bounded simply connected D, choose a conformal $f : \mathbb{D} \to D$ and distinct circle points ζ_p, ζ_q representing p, q. For $r_n \uparrow 1$, set

$$D_n = f(r_n\mathbb{D}), \qquad p_n = f(r_n\zeta_p), \quad q_n = f(r_n\zeta_q).$$

Each D_n is an analytic Jordan domain: f extends holomorphically and univalently across the compact circle $|z| = r_n$, with nonzero derivative. Choose a conformal $m : \mathbb{H} \to \mathbb{D}$ with $m(0) = \zeta_p$, $m(\infty) = \zeta_q$. The marked inverse charts

$$f_n(z) = f(r_n m(z))$$

converge locally uniformly to $f(m(z))$, giving exactly the desired marked prime-end limit, even if f has no Euclidean limit at one of the selected circle points. Tensor continuity and $T(D_n, p_n, q_n) = Q_0$ give $T(D, p, q) = Q_0$. The fixed-affine normalizer follows from SLE similarity covariance as in the preceding theorem. □

This corollary removes a reversal assumption *inside the global affine ansatz*, at the price of strong DMP and a precise continuity premise. It still supplies no argument that the original three axioms, RSW, or local target consistency force a marginal exploration law to belong to that ansatz.

15 Continuation under the corrected source-neighborhood locality

The specification at commit `0e47018` requires equality of initial curve laws whenever the physical domains and their boundary colors agree near the source; the remote target and remote domain may differ. We call this strong source locality below. We use one fixed boundary-color orientation, so two distinct color-orientation sectors are not an additional hidden label. No counterexample to the corrected three axioms in that convention is established in this continuation. Neither is the full classification proved.

There are three main positive advances: a quantitative driving-drift rigidity theorem needing no assumed regularity of quadratic variation; a common-metric theorem inside the affine-SLE ansatz requiring stability only at one straight slit-tip germ; and target-patch stability from a precise conditional unforced-crossing estimate. A coarse nonconcentration estimate also makes affine anisotropies compact. A common-color RSW shield additionally proves quantitative source-patch stability in flat and straight-slit geometries; it is not asserted for arbitrary curve laws or arbitrary domain approximations. Every analytical or coupling premise added to the project axioms is identified explicitly. The stronger wrong-coordinate obstruction concerns the known affine-SLE family, not an unknown general scaling limit.

Independent audits checked the signed-measure characteristic identities, the mirrored-slit coefficients, analytic-germ covariance, the narrow straight-tip support argument, the rough domain-control extension, and the target-patch and rank-collapse estimates. In particular, Brownian full support was not used to extend almost-sure identities to null deterministic histories without a stated stability premise.

16 A near-source drift-boundedness criterion

Status. This is a new conditional rigidity result. It does not assume conformal invariance, Brownian driving, or local-martingale driving. Instead it shows that a locally bounded *initial driving drift*, together with an absolutely continuous drift part and locality, already forces zero drift and variance six. No regularity of quadratic variation is assumed. Strong DMP then identifies the whole driving law. The boundedness and characteristic hypotheses are not derived from RSW or from the three project axioms. A finite-dimensional bulk-jet closure is given as one explicit sufficient hypothesis.

Only a particular deletion consequence of the corrected source-neighborhood locality is needed. Arbitrary target changes and the full force of corrected locality are not used in this theorem. Thus the result is compatible with, but does not exhaust, the corrected research objective.

16.1 Chart-dependent initial characteristics and their covariance

Let $f : \mathbb{H} \to D$ be an inverse chordal conformal chart, with source $f(0) = p$ and target $f(\infty) = q$, both interpreted as prime ends. For the physical ensemble in D, let W^f be its driving process in this chart, with half-plane capacity normalization

$$\partial_t g_t(z) = \frac{2}{g_t(z) - W_t^f}, \qquad W_0^f = 0.$$

Assume that it is a continuous semimartingale in its natural trace filtration, with decomposition

$$W_t^f = M_t^f + \int_0^t b_s^f \, ds, \qquad C_t^f = \langle M^f \rangle_t. \tag{DR1}$$

The drift-density paths b^f are assumed finite and right-continuous, after local stopping if necessary. No absolute continuity or regularity of C^f is assumed. At the initial time suppose

$$b_0^f = B(f) \in \mathbb{R} \tag{DR2}$$

is deterministic. It may depend on the entire physical marked domain and its conformal chart. In particular no Markov property of the single real driver is assumed. A finite deterministic initial variance rate $V(f)$ will be *derived* below from locality and (DR1)–(DR2).

Let $A \subset \overline{\mathbb{H}}$ be a half-plane hull disjoint from 0, let $h : \mathbb{H}\setminus A \to \mathbb{H}$ be hydrodynamically normalized, and set

$$\bar{h}(z) = h(z) - h(0), \qquad f_A = f \circ \bar{h}^{-1}. \tag{DR3}$$

The source is still the same physical prime end, since $\bar{h}(0) = 0$; the target is also unchanged. Put $d = h'(0) > 0$, $e = h''(0)$. Source locality, together with the usual deletion-chart calculation, will give a finite deterministic initial variance rate $V(f)$ and the covariance

$$\boxed{V(f_A) = V(f), \qquad B(f_A) = \frac{B(f)}{d} + \left(\frac{V(f)}{2} - 3\right)\frac{e}{d^2}.} \tag{DR4}$$

These are identities for *initial* characteristics and do not identify the two complete driving laws.

Here are the details without assuming a quadratic-variation density. If h_t is the evolving deletion map, then $du = h_t'(W_t)^2 dt$, and Itô's formula gives

$$d\widehat{W}_{u(t)} = h_t'(W_t)\, dM_t + h_t'(W_t) b_t\, dt + \frac{1}{2} h_t''(W_t)\, dC_t - 3h_t''(W_t)\, dt. \tag{DR5}$$

The -3 comes from

$$\partial_t h_t(z) = \frac{2h_t'(W_t)^2}{h_t(z) - h_t(W_t)} - \frac{2h_t'(z)}{z - W_t}, \qquad (\partial_t h_t)(W_t) = -3h_t''(W_t).$$

The comparison of filtrations is justified by geometric invertibility: from a deleted-domain initial trace one reconstructs its original trace and capacity, so the inverse capacity clock is adapted and its inverse is a stopping-time clock. Locality therefore compares the same trace filtration, not an unrelated enlargement. Adaptedness of an arbitrary increasing clock would not suffice for this step.

Local bracket-regularization lemma (proved). Suppose $h''(0) \neq 0$. Then on a positive initial interval, C_t is absolutely continuous and has a finite right-continuous density. In particular its initial right derivative $V(f)$ exists and is deterministic.

Proof. The deleted-domain driver also has an absolutely continuous drift, $\int \widehat{b}_u\, du$, by (DR1). Uniqueness of the continuous semimartingale decomposition applied to (DR5), after the justified capacity time change, gives the signed-measure identity

$$h_t''(W_t)\big(dC_t - 6\, dt\big) = 2\big[h_t'(W_t)^2 \widehat{b}_{u(t)} - h_t'(W_t) b_t\big] dt. \tag{DR5a}$$

The second derivative starts nonzero and remains so on a positive initial interval. On that interval the bracket is absolutely continuous, with

$$v_t = 6 + 2\frac{h_t'(W_t)^2 \widehat{b}_{u(t)} - h_t'(W_t) b_t}{h_t''(W_t)}. \tag{DR5b}$$

The derivative paths of h_t along the continuous driving point are continuous, while the two drift-density paths are right-continuous and finite. Thus v is right-continuous and finite there. In particular

$$V(f) = v_0 = 6 + 2\frac{d^2B(f_A) - dB(f)}{e} \tag{DR5c}$$

is deterministic. This is an intrinsic initial rate of C, so it does not depend on which nonzero-e deletion was used to derive it. Applying the same time change to bracket gives $V(f_A) = V(f)$. Rearranging (DR5c) gives the drift identity (DR4). □

There is always an available nonzero-e test deletion, for example one vertical slit at any fixed real point different from 0. Right-continuity makes the initial drift and variance rates intrinsic, rather than arbitrary versions of densities at a single time. The bracket density has only been proved locally at the start; its global regularity is not being presumed.

Source-neighborhood convention. In half-plane coordinates these slit deletions preserve a full neighborhood of the source end. Under f this is a prime-end neighborhood. Thus (DR4) is justified on arbitrary rough domains if the corrected locality assumption is formulated for such neighborhoods, or if these particular deletions are explicitly admissible. For regular analytic source boundaries it is ordinary Euclidean neighborhood locality. If locality is instead stated only using Euclidean balls at non-singleton source impressions, the all-rough-domain extension must remain an explicit additional hypothesis.

16.2 Two vanishing slits force both characteristics

For $\epsilon > 0$ take the reflected vertical slits

$$A_\epsilon^\pm = \{\, \pm\epsilon^2 + iy : 0 \le y \le 2\epsilon \,\}. \tag{DR6}$$

Their hydrodynamic maps are

$$h_\epsilon^\pm(z) = \pm\epsilon^2 + \sqrt{(z \mp \epsilon^2)^2 + 4\epsilon^2}, \tag{DR7}$$

with the square-root branch asymptotic to $z \mp \epsilon^2$ at infinity. Let $f_\epsilon^\pm = f \circ (h_\epsilon^\pm - h_\epsilon^\pm(0))^{-1}$. Both sequences are conformal charts of bounded simply connected domains and

$$f_\epsilon^\pm \longrightarrow f \quad \text{locally uniformly in } \mathbb{H}. \tag{DR8}$$

Indeed the slits have diameter 2ϵ and approach 0; directly from (DR7), their maps and inverse maps converge to the identity on compact subsets of $\mathbb{H}$, while $h_\epsilon^\pm(0) \to 0$. Crucially their boundary derivatives do *not* converge to the identity jet:

$$d_\epsilon = (h_\epsilon^\pm)'(0) = \frac{\epsilon}{\sqrt{\epsilon^2 + 4}} \longrightarrow 0, \qquad e_\epsilon^\pm = (h_\epsilon^\pm)''(0) = \mp\frac{4}{\epsilon(\epsilon^2 + 4)^{3/2}}. \tag{DR9}$$

In particular

$$\frac{e_\epsilon^\pm}{d_\epsilon^2} = \mp\frac{4}{\epsilon^3\sqrt{\epsilon^2 + 4}}. \tag{DR10}$$

Thus compact convergence of inverse charts permits very large second-jet changes precisely at the source boundary.

Initial rigidity theorem (proved). Fix f and assume (DR1)–(DR4) for f and the charts $f_\epsilon^\pm$. If

$$\sup_{0<\epsilon<\epsilon_0} \max\{|B(f_\epsilon^+)|, |B(f_\epsilon^-)|\} < \infty \tag{DR11}$$

for some $\epsilon_0 > 0$, then

$$B(f) = 0, \qquad V(f) = 6. \tag{DR12}$$

No continuity of B is required.

Proof. Write $b = B(f)$, $v = V(f)$ and $b_\epsilon^\pm = B(f_\epsilon^\pm)$. Equation (DR4) gives

$$b_\epsilon^\pm = \frac{b}{d_\epsilon} + \left(\frac{v}{2} - 3\right)\frac{e_\epsilon^\pm}{d_\epsilon^2}.$$

Since $e_\epsilon^- = -e_\epsilon^+$,

$$b_\epsilon^+ + b_\epsilon^- = \frac{2b}{d_\epsilon}, \qquad b_\epsilon^+ - b_\epsilon^- = (v-6)\frac{e_\epsilon^+}{d_\epsilon^2}. \tag{DR13}$$

The first right side is bounded only if $b = 0$, since $d_\epsilon \to 0$. The second is bounded only if $v = 6$, since its multiplier has magnitude asymptotic to $2\epsilon^{-3}$. This proves (DR12). □

Exact instability and weaker rate conditions. For real numbers U, C one has $\max\{|U + C|, |U - C|\} = |U| + |C|$. Hence the two drift covariances give the exact identity

$$\boxed{\max\{|b_\epsilon^+|, |b_\epsilon^-|\} = \frac{|b|\sqrt{\epsilon^2+4}}{\epsilon} + \frac{4|v/2-3|}{\epsilon^3\sqrt{\epsilon^2+4}}.} \tag{DR14}$$

There is no possible cancellation between the two reflected tests. In particular, if the displayed maximum is $o(\epsilon^{-3})$, then $v = 6$. If it is $o(\epsilon^{-1})$, then $b = 0$ and $v = 6$. Boundedness is more than sufficient. Conversely, if $v \neq 6$, its leading blow-up is $|v-6|\epsilon^{-3}$; if $v = 6$ and $b \neq 0$, its leading blow-up is $2|b|\epsilon^{-1}$. This is a concrete, quantitative obstruction to any alternative semimartingale driving law with tame initial drift under source perturbations.

16.3 Local boundedness in marked-chart topology suffices

Equip inverse marked charts with locally uniform convergence on $\mathbb{H}$, retaining the fixed preimages $0, \infty$ of source and target. If B is locally bounded at every f in this topology, then (DR8) implies (DR11). In particular continuity of B is sufficient, but unnecessarily strong. This is a hypothesis about the driving characteristic itself; weak convergence of curve laws alone does not imply it.

Conditional classification theorem (proved). Suppose a Borel family of continuous Loewner-generating exploration laws on all bounded simply connected marked prime-end domains has strong DMP and source-neighborhood locality (including the test deletions (DR6) in each chart). Suppose its drivers satisfy (DR1)–(DR2), with finite right-continuous drift-density paths and the usual restart compatibility of characteristic kernels, with no initial assumption on quadratic variation. If the initial drift map B is locally bounded in marked inverse- chart topology, then every driving process is

$$W_t^f = \sqrt{6}\, B_t,$$

and the family is chordal SLE_6 in these conformal coordinates.

Proof. The initial rigidity theorem gives $B(f) = 0$ and the derived $V(f) = 6$ for every marked inverse chart. At any deterministic rational time r, condition on the initial exploration and use strong DMP in its remaining marked domain and current conformal chart. The centered future driver is exactly the restarted driver; its initial drift is b^f_r, by right-continuity. The restarted law has initial drift zero, so $b^f_r = 0$ almost surely. Countably many rational times and right-continuity give $b^f_t = 0$ throughout each localized lifetime. Therefore all domain chart drivers are continuous local martingales.

For completeness the no-density local-martingale locality argument then identifies their brackets. With both drifts zero, (DR5a) becomes $h''_t(W_t)(dC_t - 6\,dt) = 0$. A nonzero-$e$ vertical deletion yields $C_t = 6t$ on a positive initial interval. Let

$$T = \inf\{t \geq 0 : C_t - 6t \neq 0\}.$$

This is an entrance stopping time of a continuous adapted process into an open set, in the usual right-continuous filtration. The initial zero interval gives $T > 0$. If $T < \infty$, continuity gives $C_T = 6T$ and the first-deviation definition gives nonzero values arbitrarily soon after T. Strong DMP restarted at T gives another positive zero interval, a contradiction. Thus $C_t = 6t$ throughout. Lévy's characterization gives Brownian driving, and Loewner generation identifies SLE_6. □

The Borel-kernel condition means that the family admits the standard strong conditional-kernel interpretation on random slit domains, and that the characteristics can be chosen consistently on that family. It is not a claim that deterministic-domain convergence of discrete explorations proves this property. Translation invariance is not needed in this conditional theorem. If its hypotheses hold only after one fixed physical affine normalization, the conclusion is the corresponding fixed-affine SLE_6 family; an affine change of physical coordinates is not presumed to preserve semimartingale driving in an arbitrary preselected complex structure.

16.4 A finite-dimensional closure that is completely classified

For example, fix finitely many interior points $z_j \in \mathbb{H}$ and finitely many nonnegative derivative orders m_j. Let

$$J(f) = \big(f^{(k)}(z_j) : 1 \leq j \leq N, 0 \leq k \leq m_j\big).$$

Suppose the initial drift has a representation

$$B(f) = \mathcal{B}(J(f)), \tag{DR15}$$

where $\mathcal{B}$ is locally bounded at every realized jet vector. The bracket has no assumed density or finite-dimensional representation; its initial rate is supplied by the local regularization lemma. Locally uniform convergence of conformal maps implies convergence of all these interior jets by Cauchy's formula, so (DR15) implies local boundedness of B in marked-chart topology. The conditional classification theorem therefore applies: within (DR1)–(DR2), every source-local strong-DMP family with such a locally bounded finite-dimensional *bulk-jet drift closure* is SLE_6.

This statement does not cover a closure depending on unbounded source boundary derivatives such as $f'(0)$ or a boundary pre-Schwarzian. Those quantities can change without control under (DR8), and can carry exactly the singular terms in (DR13). Nor does it show that true percolation limits have semimartingale driving in a fixed physical complex structure. The new rigorous reduction is that any non-SLE candidate with regular characteristic rates must violate the displayed near-source drift bound, in the explicit ϵ^{-1} or ϵ^{-3} manner above.

16.5 The criterion also detects a wrong affine coordinate system

Corollary (proved). Let A be an orientation-preserving real-linear map which is not a Euclidean similarity, and let the physical ensemble be the fixed-affine pullback

$$P_{D,p,q} = (A^{-1})_* \operatorname{Law}(\mathrm{SLE}_6(AD; Ap, Aq)).$$

Although this family satisfies corrected source-neighborhood locality and strong DMP, in the original Euclidean complex structure it cannot satisfy both the regular semimartingale characteristic assumptions (DR1)–(DR2) in all marked domains and the locally bounded initial-drift condition above.

Proof. If both properties held, the conditional classification theorem would make this ensemble ordinary SLE_6 in the original complex structure. The single-domain affine identifiability theorem would then make A a similarity, a contradiction. □

Thus the drift criterion selects a conformal structure. It is not a coordinate-free consequence of coarse crossing bounds: bounded affine changes preserve such bounds, whereas a wrong affine structure necessarily violates at least one of the criterion's additional analytic hypotheses. The corollary does not decide whether the failure is semimartingality, right-continuity of the drift density, deterministic initial drift, or boundedness of the initial drift; distinguishing these failures is a separate question.

16.6 What corrected locality says at a regular analytic source germ

Here is a separate necessary local structure statement that uses the full corrected locality, including changes of the distant target. It concerns initial characteristics only, not existence of a process from arbitrary coefficient choices.

Suppose the physical boundary is analytic near p and the source colors are fixed there. Let G denote this embedded colored source germ. For a chart f extending conformally across 0, define

$$a(f) = |f'(0)| > 0, \qquad P(f) = \operatorname{Re} \frac{f''(0)}{f'(0)}. \tag{DR16}$$

If another physical marked domain has the same source germ but any distant target, let k be its inverse chordal chart with $k(0) = p$. The local map $h = k^{-1} \circ f$ is analytic across 0, takes the real boundary interval to a real interval, and has $h(0) = 0$, $d = h'(0) > 0$, $e = h''(0) \in \mathbb{R}$. The two initial physical traces agree by corrected locality. The local Loewner coordinate comparison is exactly (DR4), with the same derivation from pole cancellation and Itô's formula; a globally defined deletion map is unnecessary. Consequently $V(f) = V(k)$ depends only on G.

Proposition (proved). Under the semimartingale assumptions above, corrected locality at analytic source germs is equivalent at the level of initial characteristic covariance to the existence of two source-germ quantities $V(G)$ and $\beta(G)$ such that

$$\boxed{V(f) = V(G), \qquad B(f) = a(f)\,\beta(G) + \left(3 - \frac{V(G)}{2}\right) P(f).} \tag{DR17}$$

Here "equivalent at the level of covariance" means precisely that every covariant initial-characteristic assignment has this form, and every assignment of this form obeys the local chart covariance identity. It does not mean that arbitrary V, β yield a domain Markov exploration family.

Proof. Since $k = f \circ h^{-1}$, the chain rule gives

$$a(k) = \frac{a(f)}{d}, \qquad P(k) = \frac{P(f)}{d} - \frac{e}{d^2}.$$

Write $c = V(G)/2 - 3$. Combining these transformations with $B(k) = B(f)/d + ce/d^2$ yields

$$\frac{B(k) + cP(k)}{a(k)} = \frac{B(f) + cP(f)}{a(f)}.$$

This common value is the source-germ invariant $\beta(G)$, proving (DR17). Conversely direct substitution gives the required covariance. □

Physical translation invariance makes $V(G)$ and $\beta(G)$ invariant under translations of the colored germ. If dilation covariance is separately assumed, then $V(\lambda G) = V(G)$ and $\beta(\lambda G) = \lambda^{-1}\beta(G)$. For a straight source-boundary germ, which is unchanged up to translation by dilation, this would force $\beta(G) = 0$; the dimensionless variance can still depend on the boundary orientation before an affine metric has been identified.

The boundary pre-Schwarzian term in (DR17) explains the quantitative anomaly in the vanishing-slit test. Even when the physical source germ is unchanged, $P(f_\epsilon)$ may grow as ϵ^{-3} while $f_\epsilon \to f$ on every interior compact set. Thus source locality by itself gives a connection-type transformation law, rather than vanishing drift. The locally bounded bulk closure theorem removes exactly this uncontrolled boundary dependence. The missing global step is to understand how DMP constrains these local assignments at rough, dynamically created source germs, where the analytic boundary jet in (DR16) no longer exists.

17 Rigidity from an averaged initial finite-variation characteristic

Scope. This conditional theorem weakens the preceding driving-regularity premise. The canonical finite-variation characteristic need not be absolutely continuous and need not possess a right-continuous density. We assume only a deterministic first-order tangent in probability, uniformly on shrinking initial intervals. No such property is derived from RSW or the three axioms.

Let the driver in inverse chart f have canonical decomposition

$$W^f = M^f + A^f, \qquad W_0^f = M_0^f = A_0^f = 0, \tag{FV1}$$

where M^f is a continuous local martingale and A^f is continuous, adapted, and locally of finite variation. Write $C^f = \langle M^f \rangle$. Assume for every deterministic state and inherited chordal chart that a finite deterministic number $B(f)$ satisfies

$$\frac{1}{t} \sup_{0 \le s \le t} |A_s^f - B(f)s| \xrightarrow[t \downarrow 0]{\mathbb{P}} 0. \tag{FV2}$$

An almost-sure derivative $A_t^f/t \to B(f)$ implies (FV2), but (FV2) is weaker. No bound on $\mathrm{TV}(A^f; [0,t])/t$ is assumed.

Lemma 17.1 (A small finite-variation displacement in an analytic field)**.** *Let $W = M + A$ as in (FV1), let $C = \langle M \rangle$, and suppose $\sup_{s \le t} |A_s| = O_{\mathbb{P}}(t)$ and $A_t/t \to B$ in probability. Let $H_t(x)$ be a random field analytic in x on a fixed neighborhood of zero for a positive initial time interval. Suppose it has absolutely continuous finite variation in t, and, after localization, its first three*

spatial derivatives and the first spatial derivative of $\partial_t H_t$ are bounded there. Assume $H_t'(x) \to d$ as $(t,x) \to (0,0)$. Then

$$\frac{1}{t}\int_0^t H_s'(W_s)\,dA_s \longrightarrow dB \quad \textit{in probability.} \tag{FV3}$$

Proof. Localize so M, A, W stay in the spatial neighborhood. Apply the finite-variation Itô–Wentzell formula to $F_t(x) = H_t(x + A_t) - H_t(x)$ at $x = M_t$. It gives

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^t H_s'(W_s)\,dA_s = H_t(M_t + A_t) - H_t(M_t) \\ - \int_0^t [H_s'(M_s + A_s) - H_s'(M_s)]\,dM_s \\ - \frac{1}{2}\int_0^t [H_s''(M_s + A_s) - H_s''(M_s)]\,dC_s \\ - \int_0^t [(\partial_s H_s)(M_s + A_s) - (\partial_s H_s)(M_s)]\,ds.\end{aligned}$$

The first term divided by t converges to dB by the mean-value formula. The second term is a continuous local martingale N_t with bracket at most $K^2 \sup_{s\le t} |A_s|^2 C_t$. Thus $N_t/t \to 0$ in probability: stop when $|A_s| > Lt$ or $C_s > \eta$, apply the martingale maximal inequality, then let $t \downarrow 0$, $\eta \downarrow 0$, and $L \uparrow \infty$. Here $C_t \to 0$ almost surely and $\sup |A_s|/t$ is tight. The third term divided by t is bounded by $K \sup |A_s| C_t/t = o_{\mathbb{P}}(1)$; the fourth is bounded by $K \sup |A_s| = o_{\mathbb{P}}(1)$. No total-variation estimate was used. □

Proposition 17.2 (Initial covariance without a drift density)**.** *Suppose source locality allows one test deletion with hydrodynamic map h, $d = h'(0) > 0$, $e = h''(0) \neq 0$, and both original and deleted drivers obey (FV1)–(FV2), with their canonical characteristics in the same trace filtration. Then*

$$C_t^f/t \longrightarrow V(f) \in [0,\infty) \quad \textit{in probability,}$$

where $V(f)$ is deterministic, and

$$V(f_A) = V(f), \qquad B(f_A) = \frac{B(f)}{d} + \left(\frac{V(f)}{2} - 3\right)\frac{e}{d^2}. \tag{FV4}$$

Proof. Use the same evolving deletion maps and stopping-time capacity clocks as in (DR5), now without assuming a drift density. Put $p_t = h_t'(W_t)$, $q_t = h_t''(W_t)$ and $u(t) = \int_0^t p_s^2 ds$. Uniqueness of the canonical semimartingale decomposition gives

$$\widehat{A}_{u(t)} = \int_0^t p_s\,dA_s + \frac{1}{2}\int_0^t q_s\,dC_s - 3\int_0^t q_s\,ds. \tag{FV5}$$

The deletion field satisfies the analytic-field lemma after localization; its Loewner field derivative and spatial derivatives are bounded near the uncollided source. Therefore the first integral divided by t tends to $dB(f)$, without assuming C_t/t is tight. Also $u(t)/t \to d^2$. Condition (FV2) for the deleted state implies $\widehat{A}_{u(t)}/t \to d^2 B(f_A)$: on the event $u(t) \le Kt$, bound the error by $t^{-1}\sup_{s\le Kt} |\widehat{A}_s - B(f_A)s|$, and choose fixed $K > d^2$.

Since $q_t \to e \neq 0$, (FV5) first implies C_t/t is tight: with probability tending to one q_s has fixed sign and magnitude at least $|e|/2$ on $[0,t]$, so $|\int q_s dC_s| \ge |e| C_t/2$. Consequently

$$\frac{1}{t}\int_0^t q_s\,dC_s - e\frac{C_t}{t} \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{in probability.}$$

Taking (FV5) divided by t now gives

$$V(f) = 6 + \frac{2\{d^2B(f_A) - dB(f)\}}{e}.$$

This is intrinsic, nonnegative, and deterministic. The bracket relation $\widehat{C}_{u(t)} = \int_0^t p_s^2 dC_s$ gives $V(f_A) = V(f)$. For this last step the tangents of $C, \widehat{C}$ may be evaluated at asymptotically deterministic clocks by monotonic squeezing; convergence in probability of an arbitrary signed process would not justify that step. □

Lemma 17.3 (A finite-variation process with zero right tangent at every stopping time)**.** *Let $A_0 = 0$ be a continuous adapted locally finite-variation process. If for every bounded stopping time τ before lifetime*

$$\frac{A_{\tau+h} - A_\tau}{h} \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{in probability as } h \downarrow 0, \tag{FV6}$$

then A is indistinguishably zero.

Proof. Work on a compact localized interval. Pathwise put $V_t = \mathrm{TV}(A; [0,t])$, and use its generalized inverse $\theta(u) = \inf\{t : V_t \geq u\}$ for $0 < u < V_T$. The usual arclength parametrization of a continuous finite-variation path is $G(u) = A_{\theta(u)}$: it is 1-Lipschitz, satisfies $A_t = G(V_t)$, and has $|G'(u)| = 1$ for Lebesgue almost every u. Indeed the variation of G on every interval is its interval length. The monotone function θ has a finite derivative $\theta'(u) \in [0, \infty)$ for almost every u. Exclude also the countably many levels corresponding to nontrivial flat intervals of V.

At a level where these properties hold, let $s = \theta(u)$ and $v(h) = V_{s+h} - u$. Then $v(h) > 0$ and $v(h) \to 0$ as $h \downarrow 0$. The generalized-inverse bounds $\theta((u + v(h))-) \leq s + h \leq \theta((u + v(h))+)$ and differentiability of θ at u give $h/v(h) \to \theta'(u)$. Combining this with differentiability of G gives

$$\lim_{h \downarrow 0} \frac{A_{s+h} - A_s}{h} = \begin{cases} G'(u)/\theta'(u), & \theta'(u) > 0, \\ \mathrm{sgn}(G'(u))\,\infty, & \theta'(u) = 0. \end{cases} \tag{FV7}$$

Thus the extended right derivative is nonzero at almost every variation level, including levels whose inverse belongs to a singular part of dV.

For deterministic $u > 0$ use the stopping times $\tau_u = \inf\{t : V_t \geq u\}$, truncated at a deterministic endpoint T. Fubini and the preceding pathwise statement show that for Lebesgue almost every deterministic u, on $\{\tau_u < T\}$ the quotient in (FV6) has a nonzero or infinite pathwise limit almost surely. But (FV6) gives convergence in probability to zero at this stopping time, which forbids such an event of positive probability. Thus $\mathbb{P}(\tau_u < T) = 0$ for Lebesgue almost every u, and $\mathbb{E}[V_T] = \int_0^\infty \mathbb{P}(\tau_u < T) du = 0$ after localizing V_T to be integrable. Hence $V_T = 0$ almost surely. Localization and a countable exhaustion of the lifetime prove the claim. □

Theorem 17.4 (Conditional classification from a finite-variation initial tangent)**.** *Suppose a Borel family on all relevant marked slit states has strong DMP and source locality, including the same mirrored test deletions (DR6). Suppose canonical decompositions (FV1), compatible with conditional restart in the inherited chordal charts, obey (FV2). If $B(f)$ is locally bounded in inverse-chart topology, or just satisfies the paired slit bound (DR11) at every state, the family is chordal SLE_6 in these coordinates.*

Proof. Proposition 17.2 gives exactly (DR4), hence the reflected-slit sum and difference argument gives $B(f) = 0$, $V(f) = 6$ at every deterministic state.

At a stopping time τ, the centered future driver is the driver of the remaining physical state in the inherited conformal chart. Its capacity parameter is exactly $s = t - \tau$ in the original half-plane coordinate: recentering by W_τ introduces no additional scale clock. Strong DMP and conditional-characteristic compatibility identify its canonical finite-variation part with $A_{\tau+s} - A_\tau$ under the regular conditional law. Applying (FV2) with $B = 0$, and integrating these conditional probabilities over the random state, gives (FV6). Lemma 17.3 therefore makes $A = 0$.

The same conditional restart argument gives $(C_{\tau+h} - C_\tau)/h \to 6$ in probability at every stopping time. Apply Lemma 17.3 to the continuous finite-variation process $C_t - 6t$: it is identically zero. Thus $W = M$ and $\langle M \rangle_t = 6t$ globally. Lévy's characterization and continuous Loewner generation identify SLE_6. □

Strict weakening and remaining limitation. Even an absolutely continuous drift with density $b_s = B + \sin(1/s)$, $s > 0$, has no right limit at zero, whereas $\int_0^t b_s ds = Bt + O(t^2)$ and therefore satisfies (FV2). The theorem also allows an a priori singular finite-variation drift; its exclusion is a conclusion, not an assumption. A claim that an actual exploration family has these initial characteristic tangents remains unproved. The theorem still depends on choosing one correct physical conformal structure and on tame behavior under the source slit tests.

17.1 The wrong-coordinate obstruction also only needs finite-variation tangents

Scaling lemma with probability tangents. The exact-scaling lemma (SM1)–(SM4) remains true if its drift assumption is replaced by continuous finite variation and (FV2), and its bracket assumption by $C_t/t \to v$ in probability for deterministic v. Indeed (FV2) makes $\sup_{s \le T} |c^{-1/2} A_{cs}| = O_{\mathbb{P}}(\sqrt{c}) \to 0$. Since C is increasing, a finite deterministic mesh and monotonic squeezing show

$$\sup_{s \le T} |C_{cs}/c - vs| \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{in probability.}$$

The continuous-martingale functional central limit argument in the earlier scaling lemma then applies unchanged. Exact scaling makes the whole law Brownian with variance v.

Local transfer of the tangent. In Proposition 17.2, the analytic-field argument actually gives the uniform version

$$\frac{1}{t} \sup_{s \le t} \left| \int_0^s h_r'(W_r)\, dA_r - dB(f)s \right| \longrightarrow 0 \quad \text{in probability.}$$

Use the martingale maximal inequality in its proof, and the same uniform initial bound for A. Monotonic squeezing similarly makes $C_{ts}/t \to V(f)s$ uniformly on compact s intervals in probability. Equation (FV5) therefore transfers (FV2) through a local analytic chart change, once the initial bracket tangent has been obtained; it also transfers its inverse, since the first chart derivative is positive. No total-variation rate bound is introduced by this transfer.

Corollary 17.5 (Wrong-affine obstruction under finite-variation tangents)**.** *Consider the canonical fixed-affine SLE_6 family with matrix A on all bounded marked domains. If every Euclidean chart driver admits (FV1)–(FV2), then A is a Euclidean similarity. No local boundedness of $B(f)$ is needed.*

Proof. Choose the bounded flat-source domain and one test deletion used in the bounded-domain obstruction theorem. Proposition 17.2 gives its deterministic bracket tangent in probability. Couple

its initial physical trace by known affine-SLE locality to the canonical half-plane affine-SLE trace. The local analytic chart transfer just proved gives a finite-variation decomposition and uniform deterministic drift tangent for the half-plane driver, and the same deterministic bracket tangent. Its exact Brownian scaling and the extended scaling lemma make its law ordinary Brownian driving. The boundary-swallowing-race and affine identification arguments in the half-plane obstruction theorem then give variance six and force A to be a similarity. □

18 Strong source locality inside the affine-SLE ansatz

Scope and revised axiom. Here locality means agreement of exploration laws up to exiting any common source neighborhood, including agreement of the boundary colors there; the targets and the domains outside the neighborhood may differ. This is stronger than the earlier target-preserving deletion axiom. All statements below use the revised version. We investigate the deterministic affine-SLE marginal ansatz, not arbitrary exploration laws.

For each marked domain $S = (D, p, q)$ suppose

$$P_S = (A_S^{-1})_* \,\mathrm{SLE}_6(A_S D, A_S p, A_S q), \qquad A_S \in \mathrm{GL}^+(2, \mathbb{R}). \tag{AF1}$$

Let $T(S)$ be the determinant-one representative of $[A_S^{\mathsf{T}} A_S]$. The metric-identification results elsewhere in the record make this independent of the choice of representing matrix. When invoking the domain Markov property we assume (AF1) on the resulting rough slit states as well, not merely on initially regular domains.

18.1 Exact freedom remaining without the domain Markov property

An embedded colored source germ is the germ of (D, p) at the source, including the white and black boundary sides. At a regular source it may be represented by the physical boundary curve and its interior side in an arbitrarily small disk. Denote it by $G_s(D, p)$.

Proposition 18.1 (Strong locality leaves arbitrary regular-source germ metrics)**.** *On bounded piecewise real-analytic Jordan domains with regular source, strong locality forces $T(D, p, q)$ to depend only on the colored embedded source germ. Translation covariance makes this germ function invariant under translation. Conversely, every measurable translation-invariant choice of a positive-definite projective tensor from the source germ produces, through (AF1), a translation-covariant affine-SLE family with strong locality. No domain Markov assertion is part of this converse.*

Proof. If two triples have the same regular source germ, strong locality identifies the initial laws stopped inside a common source disk. Blow up at the regular source. The limiting laws are affine images of half-plane SLE_6 from 0 to ∞. Strict monotonicity of the left-passage probability makes the two affine tensors proportional, hence their determinant-one forms equal. In particular the target and the remote domain cannot change T. Translation covariance gives the corresponding equality for translated germs, by the same local identifiability.

Conversely, choose a canonical matrix from the tensor, for example its positive-definite square root after determinant normalization. Equal source germs use the same matrix. Applying it to two domains that agree near their source gives transformed domains with the same colored source neighborhood. The usual strong locality/target-independence property of SLE_6 couples its initial paths there. Pull back the coupling. Translation covariance follows from the assumed invariance of the tensor assignment. □

Thus strong locality and translations alone do *not* give a fixed metric, even inside the affine-SLE ansatz. This is an exact obstruction, rather than a gap in a proposed proof.

18.2 An explicit source-germ example, and a direct proof that DMP excludes it

Fix $a > 0$, $a \neq 1$. At a source germ locally equal to a half-plane with boundary line ℓ, assign

$$A_s = \Pi_\ell + a\Pi_{\ell^\perp}; \tag{AF2}$$

at every other source germ assign $A_s = I$. Here locally equal means a genuine full embedded end neighborhood with straight boundary, not an artificial crosscut drawn through the interior. This rule is translation covariant and is even covariant under Euclidean similarities. It yields strong locality by the preceding proposition and the identical-germ argument on arbitrary admissible source ends. It has no fixed affine normalizer: sources on horizontal and vertical flat arcs have tensors $\mathrm{diag}(1, a^2)$ and $\mathrm{diag}(a^2, 1)$, which are not proportional. Regular-source half-plane identifiability already proves this on two sources of a rectangle.

The failure of DMP can be proved without any unestablished claim about the fractal regularity of a later hull boundary.

Lemma 18.2 (A fresh horizontal-level tip is not a flat source germ)**.** *Let a continuous curve in a rectangular domain start below a horizontal line $L = \{y = c\}$ and stop at its first hit z of L, with z in the interior of the rectangle. Suppose the target is above L. Then the target component of the slit domain is not locally equal to a half-plane at z.*

Proof. The pre-stopping trace lies below L and meets L only at z. The entire upper part of the rectangle is connected to the target and avoids the trace, so it survives in the target component. Every point of L other than z also survives: the compact trace stays a positive distance from each such point, which can be joined vertically to the upper part. Thus the removed filled hull meets L only at z.

In a sufficiently small ball about z, the full open upper half-ball belongs to the target component. Any putative straight boundary line through z would therefore have to be horizontal, since every other line enters this upper half-ball. But a horizontal boundary segment would contain other points of L, all of which are interior surviving points. Contradiction. The same argument rules out a flat full prime-end germ at this tip. □

Proposition 18.3 (The source-flat/default-identity rule violates DMP)**.** *The family (AF1)–(AF2) does not satisfy the domain Markov property.*

Proof. Take a rectangle, source at the midpoint of its bottom side, and target at the midpoint of its top side. The initial matrix is $A_h = \mathrm{diag}(1, a)$, a nonsimilarity. Stop at first hit of an intermediate horizontal line. The hit is almost surely interior: the two possible boundary endpoints of the line are fixed boundary points, and SLE_6 hits each fixed boundary point other than its marks with probability zero; an affine map preserves this statement. The path must reach the line before reaching its target.

By Lemma 18.2, the prescribed matrix at the restarted source is I. But ordinary SLE_6 DMP in the fixed A_h coordinates says that the true conditional continuation has matrix A_h. Identifiability of the affine metric for one marked bounded prime-end domain makes these continuation laws unequal, since A_h is not a similarity. Thus DMP fails. □

This example distinguishes two separate conclusions. Revised strong locality eliminates the earlier *target*-germ construction. It still permits arbitrary *source*-germ metrics before DMP is imposed; the simple flat source rule above is then genuinely excluded by DMP.

18.3 The exact DMP restriction and why full support is not enough by itself

Proposition 18.4 (Conservation of the affine metric)**.** *Within the all-state affine-SLE ansatz, DMP is equivalent to*

$$T(D_t, p_t, q) = T(D, p, q) \quad \textit{almost surely} \tag{AF3}$$

at every relevant stopping time. This is in addition to the ordinary SLE conditional kernel in the current fixed affine coordinates.

Proof. In the original affine coordinates $A = A_{D,p,q}$, ordinary SLE_6 DMP gives an affine-SLE continuation with the same matrix A. The family prescribes matrix $A_{D_t,p_t,q}$. The two laws coincide exactly when their tensors are proportional, by the one-pair metric-identification theorem. This proves both implications, including the stopping-time version when the kernels are measurable. □

Strong locality on regular starts and conservation do not immediately erase information stored in rough restart germs. Full support of Brownian driving alone cannot extend an almost-sure identity to deterministic analytic curves. For example, bounded-variation controls are dense in $C_0[0,t]$, have Brownian probability zero, and form a Borel set (total variation at most N is closed). The Borel function equal to 0 on bounded-variation controls and 1 elsewhere is almost surely constant under Brownian measure, yet differs on every smooth control. Some stability at the deterministic restart states is essential to that particular support argument. It is not silently implied by full support.

The initial-trace-germ metric decoder proved elsewhere gives a concrete reason to take this obstruction seriously: different affine metrics can already be distinguished from arbitrarily short ordered trace germs. It does not yet provide a decoder from the unlabelled boundary germ of the current target component, and therefore does not construct a DMP counterexample here.

A probabilistic alternative to topological stability. Within the more specific class of source-germ decorations, suppose a measurable metric label $t(G)$ is defined on every reachable colored source germ and DMP gives $t(G_\tau) = t(G_0)$ almost surely. If the laws ν_1, ν_2 of two restart germs are not mutually singular, their initial metrics must coincide: otherwise ν_i is supported on the disjoint measurable fiber $t^{-1}(t(G_0^i))$, which makes the laws mutually singular. Consequently a connected graph of such nonsingular restart-law comparisons would force a common tensor without any continuity assumption. This is a conditional communication criterion, not a proof that the required overlap occurs. Brownian full support supplies topological support only; mutually singular measures can have identical full topological support. Initial-germ metric decoding gives an explicit instance of that distinction. For the unrestricted affine ansatz, even expressing T as a function of a rough source germ rather than the full marked state needs local metric identifiability at that rough germ; only regular and straight-tip germs have been proved sufficient in this fragment.

18.4 Straight slit-tip germs identify the metric locally

Let $\mathcal{S} = \mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0]$, with source the slit tip 0 and target the end at infinity. The two sides of the slit are distinct colored boundary arcs. A canonical straight-tip germ in physical space agrees, up to translation, with $\mathcal{S}$ near 0, with fixed colors on its two sides.

Lemma 18.5 (Local metric identification at a straight slit tip)**.** *If two affine-SLE laws have identical initial prefixes in a common canonical straight-tip neighborhood, their projective affine tensors are equal. Consequently strong locality and translations assign one tensor T_* to all states having this canonical colored source germ.*

Proof. Blow up at the tip. The straight-boundary corner of opening 2π has a square-root uniformizing coordinate, so ordinary conformal kernel convergence identifies the two local limits as affine-SLE laws in $\mathcal{S}$ from 0 to ∞. Equality of prefixes in every fixed disk determines equality of these complete limiting laws. Stopping continuity may first be used at almost every radius and then extended to all smaller radii by composition.

It remains to identify the metric in $\mathcal{S}$. If a linear map M carries ordinary SLE_6 in $\mathcal{S}$ to SLE_6 in $M\mathcal{S}$, rotate the image slit to the negative real axis. The resulting map N preserves $\mathcal{S}$ and its slit orientation. The conformal map $\psi(z) = i\sqrt{z}$ takes $\mathcal{S}$ to $\mathbb{H}$ with marks $0, \infty$. For $z = \rho e^{i\theta}$, $-\pi < \theta < \pi$, the left-passage probability is

$$F\big(-\tan(\theta/2)\big),$$

where F is strictly increasing. Topological side preservation forces $\arg Nz = \arg z$ for every $z \in \mathcal{S}$. In particular, writing $N(x, y) = (\alpha x + \beta y, \delta y)$ with $\alpha, \delta > 0$, tests at $z = i$ and $z = 1 + i$ give $\beta = 0$ and $\alpha = \delta$. Thus M is a similarity. Apply this to the two limiting affine laws. Translations and strong locality then identify all canonical straight-tip states. □

18.5 A narrower sufficient stability premise than full domain continuity

The preceding lemma permits a support argument requiring continuity only at one kind of source germ, rather than at every marked domain.

Straight-tip stability (additional hypothesis). Suppose $f_n : \mathbb{H} \to E_n$ and $f : \mathbb{H} \to E$ are conformal maps onto bounded simply connected domains with $f_n \to f$ locally uniformly and nondegenerate limit. Mark the ends by $0, \infty$. For each fixed invertible linear L, require

$$T(LE_n, Lf_n(0), Lf_n(\infty)) \longrightarrow T(LE, Lf(0), Lf(\infty)) \tag{AF4}$$

only when the limiting physical state has a canonical horizontal straight-tip source germ, up to translation and with the prescribed colors. The approximating states may have rough boundaries. No continuity is assumed at other limiting states. This is a condition at one local germ type across its different global representatives, not a derived consequence of strong locality or DMP.

Theorem 18.6 (One stable slit-germ type forces a common regular-domain metric)**.** *Assume the all-state affine-SLE ansatz, strong DMP, revised strong locality, translation covariance, and straight-tip stability (AF4). Then one fixed matrix normalizes every marginal on bounded piecewise real-analytic Jordan domains with regular source and target. Neither geometric reversal nor full marked-domain continuity is required.*

Proof. By Lemma 18.5, every state with the canonical straight-tip germ has the same determinant-one tensor T_*. Fix a regular initial triple and its matrix A. Choose a simple deterministic arc from its source into its interior that ends with a horizontal straight segment traversed from left to right. The arc stays away from the target and can be chosen piecewise analytic, smooth at its finitely many joins. Its final point lies in an interior disk and no earlier part of the arc enters a smaller disk about that point. The resulting slit source therefore has exactly the canonical germ, with the same fixed boundary colors.

In A coordinates, uniformize the initial domain by $f : \mathbb{H} \to AD$, source 0, target ∞. The chosen simple arc has a continuous Loewner control w_* on a finite capacity interval $[0, t]$. For every continuous control w on this interval define the inverse chart of the remaining state by

$$f_t^w(z) = f\big((g_t^w)^{-1}(z + w(t))\big). \tag{AF5}$$

The inverse Loewner ODE shows $w \mapsto f_t^w$ continuous from the uniform norm to locally uniform convergence on $\mathbb{H}$. No trace-continuity theorem is needed for general approximating controls. At $w = w_*$ the physical state $A^{-1} f_t^{w_*}(\mathbb{H})$ has the canonical germ. Thus (AF4), with $L = A^{-1}$, makes the metric functional of (AF5) continuous at w_*.

Under the original affine-SLE law, the driving control is $\sqrt{6}B$. Conservation (AF3) says its restarted metric is the original tensor almost surely. Brownian measure has full uniform support on $C_0[0,t]$. If the metric at w_* differed from the original tensor, continuity at w_* would give a positive-Brownian-probability neighborhood with different metrics, contradicting conservation. Hence the original tensor equals the metric at the deterministic slit state, which is T_*. The argument applies to every regular initial triple. Similarity covariance removes the residual scalar and orthogonal factors from the representing matrices. □

Extension at the marked-domain-control level. If the all-state ansatz and (AF4) are formulated in inverse conformal charts, the same proof gives a common tensor on *all bounded simply connected prime-end states*, without assuming an initially regular Euclidean boundary. Here are the extra deterministic details. Given $f : \mathbb{H} \to AD$ with source $f(0)$, first use the zero driving control for a positive time. Its vertical chart slit has a positive-time endpoint in AD. The physical image of the slit is analytic near that endpoint, because f is conformal at its interior preimage. Earlier parts of the slit cannot accumulate at this endpoint: that would contradict continuity of f^{-1} at an interior point. Its local source domain is therefore a straightenable analytic slit of opening 2π.

Continue from this tip along a simple physical arc which initially avoids the old slit, stays in the remaining domain, and ends with an isolated horizontal straight segment traversed from left to right. Such an arc exists by polygonal connectivity of an open planar domain, with smoothing away from the final straight segment. In the current normalized half-plane chart it is a simple curve starting at the accessible tip and otherwise interior, hence has a continuous Loewner driver starting at zero. Concatenating the initial zero driver and this continuation driver is a continuous control on a finite interval. Its final physical state has the canonical source germ, exactly as in the regular proof. Conservation, continuity at this one limiting germ type, and Brownian full support again force the initial tensor to be T_*.

This argument constructs Loewner domain states; it does not assert that an initial non-singleton prime-end impression has a Euclidean landing point. If the model is restricted to Euclidean continuous curves including their initial endpoints, retain Theorem 18.6 on the regular class. The extension is valid in the inverse-chart/prime-end formulation of the all-state affine ansatz used in (AF4).

Proposition 18.7 (Pointwise analytic-history consistency is another sufficient premise)**.** *In Theorem 18.6, straight-tip stability may be replaced by this explicit condition: for every regular initial state and every deterministic simple piecewise analytic initial arc of the kind used in the proof, the family's law in the resulting slit state is the ordinary SLE conditional continuation in the initial fixed affine coordinates. Under this condition, one fixed metric again normalizes all regular-domain marginals.*

Proof. Choose the arc ending in a canonical horizontal slit germ. The pointwise condition gives its tensor equal to the original tensor. Strong locality and translations make the slit state's tensor T_*. No support or continuity argument is needed. □

This condition is not automatically part of ordinary stochastic DMP. Analytic deterministic histories have probability zero under Brownian driving, and a regular conditional kernel is determined only almost surely. Requiring its specified affine-SLE extension to agree at those histories is extra

pointwise consistency. The proposition is therefore a conditional theorem, not a proof that the revised three axioms already force one metric.

Precise remaining issue. This theorem substantially narrows the stability needed by the support method, but it does not remove stability altogether. Without (AF4), the support argument cannot rule out a conserved label encoded in rough source germs. Neither the existence of such a label nor its impossibility under strong locality and DMP has been proved. The task of deriving the affine-SLE ansatz from arbitrary exploration laws remains separate and open.

19 A nonconcentration estimate bounds affine anisotropy

This result is a concrete use of a coarse curve estimate. It does not identify a metric, but makes the possible normalized metrics compact. It concerns the affine-SLE ansatz in a flat source half-plane, not an unspecified coloring associated to arbitrary curve laws.

For an orientation-preserving real-linear map B carrying $\mathbb{H}$ onto itself, let μ_B be the law of $B\eta$, where $\eta \sim \mathrm{SLE}_6(\mathbb{H}; 0, \infty)$. Suppose a collection $\mathcal{B}$ obeys a uniform small-ball estimate

$$\sup_{B\in\mathcal{B}} \sup_{z\in\overline{\mathbb{H}}\setminus\{0\}} \mu_B\{\gamma \cap B(z, \rho|z|) \neq \varnothing\} \le u(\rho), \qquad \lim_{\rho\downarrow 0} u(\rho) = 0. \tag{6}$$

An example of the required numerical form is $u(\rho) = C\rho^\alpha$. Such bounds are natural consequences of uniform unforced-annulus estimates in this half-plane geometry: the source and target are outside a fixed outer ball centered at z, so entry into a much smaller ball is an unforced annulus crossing. This implication must use the conditional curve estimate in its precise form, rather than assume a coloring exists for an arbitrary path ensemble.

Proposition 19.1 (Compactness of normalized metrics)**.** *Under (6), the condition numbers $\|B\|\,\|B^{-1}\|$ for $B \in \mathcal{B}$ are uniformly bounded. Equivalently, the determinant-one conformal tensors of B^{-1} stay in a compact subset of the positive-definite determinant-one matrices.*

Proof. Suppose otherwise, and choose a sequence with diverging condition number. Ordinary SLE_6 is invariant under scalar spatial dilations, so replacing B_n by $B_n/\|B_n\|$ does not change μ_{B_n} or its condition number. Pass to a subsequence with $B_n \to M$, $\|M\| = 1$, $\det M = 0$. Thus M has rank one and $M\overline{\mathbb{H}} \subset \overline{\mathbb{H}}$. Write $Mz = v\ell(z)$ with $|v| = 1$ and a nonzero real-linear functional ℓ.

An SLE_6 trace on any positive capacity interval is almost surely not contained in a prescribed straight line. One can use the standard nondegeneracy of Brownian driving here: a strictly growing straight-ray Loewner trace has a deterministic driver of the form $c\sqrt{t}$, whereas Brownian motion almost surely has no such trajectory. Therefore $\max_{0\le t\le 1} |\ell(\eta(t))| > 0$ almost surely. Choose $\delta > 0$ so that this maximum exceeds 2δ with probability greater than $3/4$. At least one choice of sign $\sigma \in \{+1, -1\}$ has

$$\mathbb{P}\{\max_{0\le t\le 1} \sigma\ell(\eta(t)) > 2\delta\} > 3/8.$$

Fix that sign and put $z_0 = \sigma\delta v \neq 0$. By continuity and $\eta(0) = 0$, $M\eta$ hits z_0 on the displayed event. In particular $z_0 \in \overline{\mathbb{H}}$.

On each sample the compact trace $\eta[0, 1]$ is bounded, so $B_n\eta \to M\eta$ uniformly on this interval. Consequently, for every fixed $\rho > 0$,

$$\liminf_n \mu_{B_n}\{\gamma \cap B(z_0, \rho|z_0|) \neq \varnothing\} \ge \mathbb{P}\{M\eta[0, 1] \text{ hits } z_0\} > 3/8.$$

Choosing ρ with $u(\rho) < 3/8$ contradicts (6). Uniform boundedness of the condition numbers follows. The tensor conclusion is elementary singular-value normalization. □

The proposition does not force equality of different metrics: every uniformly bounded collection of affine distortions can still contain many members. Its use is compactness in attempts to recover metric continuity from convergence of exploration laws, rather than postulating continuity of a hidden metric label. Establishing the necessary convergence at rough slit tips remains separate.

20 Source locality, microscopic memory, and quantitative target stability

Current status under the revised axiom. The present project specification compares any two colored marked domains which agree near the source, including different targets. The earlier terminal-tangent construction does not satisfy this stronger axiom. This investigation has not produced an unconditional counterexample to the revised single-color-convention conjecture. It does prove a quantitative boundary stability statement from a precise conditional crossing estimate, and it isolates the exact additional state-recovery step needed for a source-germ counterexample. Near-critical configuration convergence is not used as a substitute for ordered exploration-kernel convergence.

20.1 What an affine source-germ counterexample would require

Let $\mathfrak{G}_s$ be the space of embedded colored source prime-end germs, with full end neighborhoods retained. Fix finitely or countably many orientation-preserving invertible matrices A_i and a deterministic Borel label $\pi : \mathfrak{G}_s \to I$. Consider

$$P_{D,p,q} = \nu_{D,p,q}^{A_{\pi(G_s(D,p))}}. \tag{SO1}$$

Unlike a target label, this label is automatically unchanged when two marked domains agree in a source neighborhood. It need not be unchanged after an exploration step.

Proposition 20.1 (A precise conditional source-label construction)**.** *Suppose π is translation covariant, and suppose that for every initial marked domain and every admissible finite stopping time of the fixed-label affine SLE exploration,*

$$[A_{\pi(G_s(D_t,p_t))}^{\mathsf{T}} A_{\pi(G_s(D_t,p_t))}] = [A_{\pi(G_s(D,p))}^{\mathsf{T}} A_{\pi(G_s(D,p))}] \qquad \textit{almost surely.} \tag{SO2}$$

Then (SO1) has strong DMP, the revised source-neighborhood locality, and translation covariance. If two regular source germs receive genuinely different projective tensors, the ensemble cannot have a single fixed affine SLE normalization.

Proof. The rough-domain affine identifiability and DMP criterion in the research record say exactly that (SO2) is the DMP condition within this deterministic affine ansatz. When two source neighborhoods agree, their labels agree; the two laws therefore use the same fixed matrix. Ordinary SLE_6 source locality, with the matching boundary colors, couples their prefixes through that neighborhood; pulling back the coupling proves the revised locality. Translation covariance follows from that of the label and SLE. Finally, local affine identifiability at a regular start identifies the projective tensor from its initial prefix law, excluding a common normalizer when the assigned tensors differ. □

Condition (SO2) is not established for a nonconstant source-germ label. The proved initial ordered-trace-germ decoder does not establish it. A remaining slit domain has an *unlabelled accessible*

frontier, while the decoder uses the chronological order of a trace started from a smooth boundary. Filling swallowed bubbles can erase parts of that order. Furthermore a usable label must work at every admissible stopping time. Decoding at each separate deterministic time would not by itself supply that stronger assertion.

One possible route is to show that a constant affine metric can be recovered from every nonempty open piece of an SLE accessible frontier. A simultaneous statement on a countable spatial basis could then handle all tip neighborhoods, avoiding the unjustified intersection of uncountably many probability-one events. No such frontier theorem is proved here; SLE duality alone does not give the required universal measurable decoder. Therefore (SO1)–(SO2) is a useful construction criterion, not a completed counterexample.

For a finite collection of matrices with bounded condition numbers, ordinary affine SLE marginals retain uniform versions of the standard unforced-quad crossing bounds, by quasiconformal modulus distortion. Consequently marginal crossing bounds would not on their own contradict a hypothetical conserved-label construction. This does not assert that the resulting ensemble comes from a single coloring or satisfies a configuration-level RSW statement.

20.2 An independent-metric-noise construction degenerates

The tempting alternative of putting independent bounded conformal structures at continuum points cannot produce a measurable random Beltrami field. Here is a slightly stronger formulation.

Lemma 20.2 (No independently scattered bounded random density)**.** *Let $X(\omega, z)$ be a jointly measurable complex random function on $\mathbb{R}^2$ with $|X| \le K$ almost surely. Suppose the random variables*

$$X(B) = \int_B X(z)\, dz$$

are independent for disjoint bounded Borel sets B. Then $X(\omega, z) = \mathbb{E}[X(z)]$ for Lebesgue-almost every z, almost surely. In particular a stationary such field is almost surely a deterministic constant almost everywhere.

Proof. Partition a bounded rectangle B into rectangles B_j of maximum area at most δ. Independence and boundedness give

$$\operatorname{Var} X(B) = \sum_j \operatorname{Var} X(B_j) \le 4K^2 \sum_j |B_j|^2 \le 4K^2 |B| \delta.$$

Letting $\delta \downarrow 0$ proves that $X(B)$ is deterministic. Intersecting the full-probability events for rectangles with rational vertices, and using uniqueness of locally finite absolutely continuous measures, gives the first assertion. Under stationarity the mean function is constant almost everywhere. □

For a bounded Beltrami coefficient $|\mu| \le k < 1$, this rules out nontrivial independently scattered metric noise. Nontrivial stationary coefficients with spatial correlation are possible, but exploration then reveals information about coefficient values away from the revealed trace. Annealed DMP in an undecorated slit domain is not automatic. That latter statement is an obstruction to the proposed proof strategy, not a nonexistence theorem for all random-metric models.

20.3 A quantitative stability consequence of source locality

We state the crossing input precisely rather than call it "RSW" without specifying a path implication. Assume constants $C < \infty$ and $\alpha > 0$ such that, conditional on any explored initial segment, the

probability that the remaining curve makes an *unforced* crossing of an annulus $A(z, r, R)$ is at most

$$C(r/R)^{\alpha}. \tag{SO3}$$

Here a component of the annulus in the remaining target domain is unforced when it does not separate the current source from the target. In particular, if those ends can be joined inside $B(z, r)$ in the remaining domain, every crossing of this annulus is unforced. The conditional formulation is crucial. It is a standard type of hypothesis in the Kemppainen–Smirnov framework; see A. Kemppainen and S. Smirnov, *Random curves, scaling limits and Loewner evolutions*, Ann. Probab. 45 (2017), 698–779, https://arxiv.org/abs/1212.6215. The argument below uses (SO3) directly; it does not claim to derive it from bare rectangle crossing bounds for an arbitrary path ensemble.

Theorem 20.3 (Localized target perturbations are small in curve law)**.** *Consider two colored marked Jordan domains (D_i, p, q_i), $i = 1, 2$, whose colored domains agree outside $B(z, \epsilon)$, with common source $p \notin \overline{B(z, R_0)}$ and targets $q_i \in B(z, \epsilon)$. Suppose the revised source locality holds and both exploration laws satisfy (SO3) with the same constants. Couple the common prefixes through first entry of $\overline{B(z, 2\epsilon)}$. Assume that, at this entry, the current source and target can be joined in their respective remaining domains inside $B(z, 4\epsilon)$, almost surely. Then, for $4\epsilon < R < R_0$, there is a coupling of the full curves with*

$$\mathbb{P}\{d_{\mathrm{F}}(\gamma_1, \gamma_2) > 2R\} \le 2C(4\epsilon/R)^{\alpha}, \tag{SO4}$$

where d_{F} is oriented uniform Fréchet distance. Consequently the distances between the two curve laws tend to zero as $\epsilon \downarrow 0$; convergence to a common limit follows if either family has a limit. After fixing a spatial unit, their Prokhorov distance, and their bounded Lipschitz distance for the truncated Fréchet metric, are $O(\epsilon^{\alpha/(\alpha+1)})$.

Proof. The two colored domains coincide in the source neighborhood $\mathbb{R}^2 \setminus \overline{B(z, 2\epsilon)}$. The revised locality therefore identifies the laws of their prefixes stopped on the circle of radius 2ϵ. Use a common prefix and the regular conditional tail kernels to obtain a full coupling with the correct marginals. No agreement of the two tails is asserted.

At this stopping time the connection hypothesis makes every crossing of $A(z, 4\epsilon, R)$ unforced in either remaining domain. Estimate (SO3) therefore bounds the conditional probability that either tail exits $B(z, R)$ by $C(4\epsilon/R)^{\alpha}$. The union bound gives twice this quantity for the probability that at least one tail exits.

On the complementary event, the two curves have a common ordered prefix and both remaining tails stay in a ball of diameter $2R$. Aligning the common prefix and then reparameterizing their tails gives $d_{\mathrm{F}}(\gamma_1, \gamma_2) \le 2R$. This proves (SO4). The coupling definition of Prokhorov distance gives a bound by $\max\{2R, 2C(4\epsilon/R)^{\alpha}\}$. Bounded Lipschitz test functions give, for example, $2R+4C(4\epsilon/R)^{\alpha}$. Taking R proportional to $\epsilon^{\alpha/(\alpha+1)}$ proves the stated rate. □

A sufficient geometric situation for the connection hypothesis. Suppose the original domain is a half-plane in $B(z, R_0)$, each modified domain is Jordan, and all modifications and their target points are inside $B(z, \epsilon)$. The half-annulus $B(z, 2\epsilon) \setminus \overline{B(z, \epsilon)}$ in that half-plane is connected and unchanged. A target access arc reaches this half-annulus from inside the smaller ball. At first entry of the radius-2ϵ ball the earlier trace has no point in its interior. Thus the entering target-side prime end connects through the unchanged half-annulus to the target access arc inside $B(z, 4\epsilon)$, without crossing the explored trace. Filling non-target components does not remove this connection. This verifies the hypothesis in that locally flat situation. For a wild target patch one must check the connection condition; proximity of the two Euclidean endpoints alone does not establish it.

What this rules out and what it leaves open. The theorem proves a genuine boundary-continuity consequence of strengthened locality plus a specified conditional unforced-crossing bound. Remote localized target perturbations cannot change a macroscopic path law by a fixed amount under these hypotheses. This is relevant to schemes that store information at a distant target. It does not establish continuity under perturbations of the source itself: when two source germs differ, the revised locality supplies no common initial prefix, and the preceding coupling argument does not start. Thus it does not yet eliminate (SO1)–(SO2) or prove the marked-chart continuity needed by the conditional affine-ansatz classification.

20.4 Color orientation is a separate formulation issue

If a state space includes *both* boundary-color orientations as separate sectors, black-on-left and black-on-right relative to the oriented exploration are conserved by DMP, and colored source locality never compares those two sectors. Assigning one fixed affine matrix to one sector and a different fixed affine matrix to the other then gives an exact example with strong locality, DMP, and translations, with no common matrix across the two sectors. Local affine identifiability proves non-equivalence when the tensors are not proportional.

This is *not* a counterexample when the project notation fixes the usual one-color convention for every (D, p, q), as we assume in the current core investigation. In that convention only one of the sectors is present. Likewise a two-ended exploration or reversal argument must track the fact that reversal exchanges the color orientation; no color-exchange symmetry at a critical density different from $1/2$ is supplied by the three axioms.

21 A wrong affine metric cannot have tame driving drift in every bounded domain

Status. The conclusion here is stronger than the earlier wrong-coordinate consequence of drift boundedness. For a fixed non-similarity affine deformation of SLE_6, regular semimartingale driving with absolutely continuous right-continuous drift cannot hold in every bounded domain in the wrong Euclidean complex structure. No local boundedness of the initial drift functional is needed. The proof uses exact scale invariance only for the *known fixed-affine SLE_6 half-plane law*; it does not assume that arbitrary critical subsequential limits are scale invariant. All characteristic regularity assumptions remain explicit.

21.1 Exact Brownian scaling and a regular initial bracket

Scaling lemma (proved). Let W be a continuous real process on $[0, \infty)$ with $W_0 = 0$, whose law has exact Brownian scaling:

$$(c^{-1/2} W_{ct})_{t \geq 0} \overset{\text{law}}{=} (W_t)_{t \geq 0} \qquad (c > 0). \tag{SM1}$$

Suppose up to a strictly positive stopping time it is a continuous semimartingale

$$W_t = M_t + \int_0^t b_s \, ds, \tag{SM2}$$

where $M_0 = 0$ is a continuous local martingale and b is finite and right-continuous at 0. Suppose its bracket has a finite deterministic initial right derivative

$$\lim_{t \downarrow 0} \frac{\langle M \rangle_t}{t} = v \in [0, \infty) \quad \text{almost surely.} \tag{SM3}$$

Then the entire law of W is that of $\sqrt{v}B$. This includes the identically zero process if $v = 0$.

Proof. Fix $T < \infty$ and stop the local decomposition at a positive initial localizing time. As $c \downarrow 0$, with probability tending to one the whole interval $[0, cT]$ lies before that time. Right-continuity of b gives

$$\sup_{t \le T} \left| c^{-1/2} \int_0^{ct} b_s \, ds \right| \le \sqrt{c}\, T \sup_{s \le cT} |b_s| \longrightarrow 0$$

almost surely on the localized event. Writing $C_t = \langle M \rangle_t$, (SM3) implies

$$\sup_{t \le T} |C_{ct}/c - vt| \longrightarrow 0. \tag{SM4}$$

Indeed $|C_{ct}/c - vt| \le t \sup_{0 < s \le cT} |C_s/s - v|$. The continuous-martingale functional central limit theorem now gives $c^{-1/2} M_{c\cdot} \Rightarrow \sqrt{v}B$ on $C[0, T]$. One may see this directly from Dambis–Dubins–Schwarz: extend its Brownian motion if necessary and write

$$c^{-1/2} M_{ct} = B^{(c)}_{C_{ct}/c}, \qquad B^{(c)}_u = c^{-1/2} \widetilde{B}_{cu}.$$

Each $B^{(c)}$ has standard Brownian law. Uniform bracket convergence to the deterministic clock and the Brownian modulus of continuity imply the stated limit; independence between $B^{(c)}$ and the bracket is unnecessary. Adding the negligible drift gives the same limit for W. By exact scaling, however, each rescaled process already has the law of W on $[0, T]$. That law is therefore Brownian with variance v. Arbitrariness of T proves the assertion. □

The regular initial bracket is not automatic for a general self-similar continuous process. In the affine-SLE application below it follows from locality and absolutely continuous drift in two domain charts, using the local bracket-regularization identity.

21.2 The half-plane affine-SLE obstruction

Let A be an invertible orientation-preserving real-linear map and let η be chordal SLE_6 in $A\mathbb{H}$ from 0 to ∞. Put $\gamma = A^{-1}\eta \subset \overline{\mathbb{H}}$ and let W be its half-plane-capacity driving function. Its continuous Loewner generation and infinite capacity lifetime are supplied by the affine-admissibility result already proved in the research record. Its law has exact Brownian scaling (SM1): ordinary SLE is dilation covariant, A commutes with positive scalar dilations, and capacity scales by the square of physical length.

Proposition (proved). If this W satisfies (SM2)–(SM3), then A is a Euclidean similarity.

Proof. The scaling lemma makes W ordinary Brownian driving of variance v. Thus the trace is ordinary chordal SLE_v in $\mathbb{H}$. We identify v without a Hausdorff-dimension theorem.

For $\kappa \le 4$ the nonzero real boundary points are never swallowed by SLE_κ: their Loewner distances divided by $\sqrt{\kappa}$ are Bessel processes of dimension $1 + 4/\kappa \ge 2$ (the case $\kappa = 0$ is immediate). An affine image of SLE_6 swallows boundary points, so $v > 4$. For any $\kappa > 4$, the boundary-race calculation gives

$$\mathbb{P}_\kappa(\tau_y < \tau_x) = F_\kappa\!\left(\frac{-x}{y - x}\right), \qquad F_\kappa(r) = \frac{\displaystyle\int_0^r [u(1-u)]^{-4/\kappa}\, du}{\displaystyle\int_0^1 [u(1-u)]^{-4/\kappa}\, du}, \quad x < 0 < y. \tag{SM5}$$

This includes $\kappa \geq 8$. To check it, the ratio $R = -X/(Y - X)$ has generator

$$\frac{\kappa}{2}\frac{d^2}{dr^2} + \frac{2(1-2r)}{r(1-r)}\frac{d}{dr}$$

after $ds = dt/(Y - X)^2$. Its scale density is $[r(1-r)]^{-4/\kappa}$, integrable at both ends exactly when $\kappa > 4$. The first swallowing is finite almost surely by the Bessel description; simultaneous swallowing is impossible since $Y - X$ is positive and nondecreasing. Bounded optional stopping gives (SM5).

Rotate $A\mathbb{H}$ conformally back to $\mathbb{H}$. The resulting map has matrix

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha & \beta \\ 0 & \delta \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \alpha, \delta > 0.$$

It acts on the real boundary by $x \mapsto \alpha x$, so it preserves the ratio $-x/(y - x)$ and the topological swallowing order. The law of γ therefore has boundary-race function F_6, while its Brownian driving gives F_v. Equality for every $r \in (0, 1)$ forces $v = 6$: compare the derivatives in (SM5), proportional respectively to $[r(1-r)]^{-4/v}$ and $[r(1-r)]^{-2/3}$.

Finally $T^{-1}\mathrm{SLE}_6(\mathbb{H}; 0, \infty)$ is ordinary SLE_6. Half-plane affine identifiability now implies T is a similarity. For completeness, the strictly increasing SLE_6 left-passage function

$$L(u) = \frac{\int_{-\infty}^{u}(1+s^2)^{-2/3}\,ds}{\int_{-\infty}^{\infty}(1+s^2)^{-2/3}\,ds}$$

and preservation of topological side give $L(u) = L((\alpha u + \beta)/\delta)$ for all real u. Thus $\alpha = \delta$ and $\beta = 0$. Rotation does not affect whether A is a similarity, proving the proposition. □

21.3 Transfer from bounded-domain regularity to the half-plane germ

The preceding proposition is already a complete unbounded-domain statement. The following additional argument shows why requiring the tame drift structure in *every bounded domain* is enough to trigger it. We spell out the local coordinate transfer, rather than silently assume semimartingality is preserved by a general physical affine map.

Bounded-domain obstruction theorem (proved). Consider the canonical fixed-affine SLE_6 family

$$P_{D,p,q} = (A^{-1})_* \,\mathrm{Law}(\mathrm{SLE}_6(AD; Ap, Aq))$$

on bounded simply connected marked domains. Suppose in the original Euclidean complex structure every domain-chart driver is a continuous semimartingale whose finite-variation part is $\int_0^t b_s\,ds$, with finite right-continuous drift density and deterministic initial value $B(f)$, consistently under the usual conditional kernel interpretation. Then A is a Euclidean similarity. No boundedness or continuity of the map $f \mapsto B(f)$ is assumed.

Proof. Choose a bounded half-disk $D \subset \mathbb{H}$ with 0 in the interior of its real diameter, and a distinct target on that diameter away from 0. Choose the boundary colors so they agree near 0 with the half-plane problem $(\mathbb{H}, 0, \infty)$. Let $\phi : D \to \mathbb{H}$ be its chordal chart sending these two marks to $0, \infty$. It extends analytically across 0, with $\phi'(0) > 0$.

The local bracket-regularization lemma applies to this bounded-domain driver: delete one further vertical slit in its ϕ chart, away from its marks, with nonzero $h''(0)$. Both domains have tame absolutely continuous drift by hypothesis. The signed-measure identity

$$h_t''(W_t)(dC_t - 6\,dt) = 2\big[h_t'(W_t)^2\widehat{b}_{u(t)} - h_t'(W_t)b_t\big]dt$$

therefore gives a finite right-continuous initial bracket density in D, with deterministic initial value v_D.

Corrected source-neighborhood locality of ordinary SLE_6, preserved by the fixed map A^{-1}, couples this bounded-domain curve to the canonical affine-SLE_6 half-plane curve so that their physical initial segments are identical until leaving a sufficiently small half-neighborhood of 0. This uses ordinary SLE_6 locality including distant target changes; it is not a new hypothesis about an unknown nonconformal family. On that common initial trace, the coordinate change is the analytic map ϕ at the source.

A local analytic coordinate change and its inverse preserve the tame semimartingale structure just obtained. More explicitly, if t is physical half-plane capacity and u is the bounded-chart capacity, the evolving local map satisfies

$$W_D(u(t)) = h_t(W_H(t)), \qquad \dot{u}(t) = h_t'(W_H(t))^2.$$

Initially $h_0 = \phi$, so $h_0'(0) > 0$ and all required local derivatives are finite. Before the trace leaves the common neighborhood, localize so the first derivative stays bounded away from zero and the derivatives stay bounded. Both capacity clocks are adapted functions of the same initial trace; their inverses are stopping-time clocks. The inverse field h_t^{-1} has finite variation in time, as follows by differentiating the Loewner composition. Applying the finite-variation Itô–Wentzell formula to the semimartingale W_D, and changing the capacity clock, produces a continuous-semimartingale decomposition of W_H on a positive initial interval. Its drift is absolutely continuous and right-continuous, and its initial bracket density is the same scalar v_D. These conclusions use only a *conformal local chart transition*, not the nonconformal map A.

For an explicit initial check, writing $d = \phi'(0)$, $e = \phi''(0)$, the transferred rates obey

$$V_H = v_D, \qquad B_H = dB_D - \left(\frac{v_D}{2} - 3\right)\frac{e}{d}, \tag{SM6}$$

so both are finite and deterministic. Thus the canonical half-plane driver satisfies (SM2)–(SM3). Its exact scaling and the half-plane proposition force A to be a similarity. □

Only a bounded domain flat at its source and one of its source-preserving slit deletions are needed for the bracket part of this contradiction. The full all-bounded-domain assumption is a convenient sufficient formulation. The obstruction does not identify the precise failure for a particular wrong affine metric: semimartingality, absolute continuity or right-continuity of the drift, or deterministic initial drift may fail. It does show that at least one must fail somewhere. It supplies no argument that an unknown exploration family admits a correct affine normalization with tame drift.

22 A discrete source shield and stability of two exploration starts

Status and model. The deterministic shielding statement and the ensuing probabilistic estimate are proved here for independent site percolation on a triangular-lattice triangulation of a Jordan disk. Boundary vertices are wired black or white, with exactly two color changes, the marked source and target. The exploration is the nonbranching face-dual black–white interface between those changes. The same argument applies to a cellular model with the corresponding nonbranching primal/dual geometry and the stated white RSW bounds. It is an actual common-color coupling argument. It is *not* inferred for an arbitrary random-curve family from abstract locality or G2 alone.

Work at mesh δ. Two triangulated domains, their source positions, and their boundary colors may differ inside $B(p, \epsilon)$, but agree outside it. Their common target lies outside $B(p, R_0)$. Outside

the source patch and inside this latter ball, assume the common geometry is either a lattice half-plane with straight boundary, or a canonical thin straight slit with its two boundary sides. The lattice approximations are chosen with free first rows adjacent to the wired boundary rows; slit width is $O(\delta)$. The black and white wired sides are the same for the two configurations outside the patch. Couple all free colors outside the patch identically. Those shared colors have the independent percolation law. The colors inside the patch may be coupled arbitrarily, with their correct marginal laws.

22.1 The deterministic one-edge crosscut

In a triangular face, either zero or two of its primal edges have endpoints of different colors. Hence the dual interface graph has degree zero or two at every interior dual vertex. In the Dobrushin disk it has a unique open simple path between the source and target; other components are loops.

Lemma 22.1 (A one-heterochromatic-edge shield)**.** *Let a simple primal crosscut c of a triangulated disk connect a white wired boundary vertex to a black wired boundary vertex. Suppose every edge of c is white–white except its final edge e, which joins a white* interior *vertex to the black boundary vertex. Suppose c separates the entire source patch from the target. Then the exploration must use the dual edge e^*, with the direction determined by its black and white sides. After using e^* it cannot reenter the source side of the crosscut.*

Consequently, if the same such crosscut and its colors occur in both configurations above, their explorations have identical ordered suffixes from e^* to the common target.

Proof. The source–target dual path must cross the primal crosscut. Primal and dual vertices are distinct, and dual edges cross primal edges only at their matched transverse intersections. No interface edge can cross a white–white primal edge. Thus the crossing must be e^*, and matching colors give the same direction in both configurations.

The dual interface path is simple, so it cannot traverse e^* twice. All other primal edges of c remain monochromatic, so they cannot be crossed later either. The path therefore stays on the target side after using e^*. In particular it never returns to the altered source patch. Outside the patch the two triangulations and all colors coincide. At each subsequent dual vertex the outgoing edge is uniquely determined by the local colors and the incoming edge. Starting at the same directed edge e^*, the two paths consequently have the same entire suffix. □

Using boundary *vertices* in this formulation avoids an ambiguity of cell-exterior pictures: e is an interior primal edge incident to a boundary vertex, so its dual edge is an ordinary interior edge. Neither a crossing through a dual/primal common vertex nor an unexplained passage around the end of a physical boundary edge is being used.

22.2 Uniform probability of a white arch

Assume a uniform white RSW lower bound for fixed-aspect rectangles of free vertices. No connection to a prescribed individual vertex is assumed. We give the geometry for a horizontal half-plane source, translated to $p = 0$, with black boundary on the negative real side and white boundary on the positive side. Let $r \gg \epsilon + \delta$.

Use a white vertical crossing in each of

$$[-3r, -2r] \times [0, 3r], \qquad [2r, 3r] \times [0, 3r],$$

and a white horizontal crossing of

$$[-3r, 3r] \times [r, 2r].$$

At the bottom of a stem, start the rectangle in the first free vertex row, not in the fixed wired row. Rounding by $O(\delta)$ changes the aspect ratios by a uniformly bounded amount. The crossings in the overlapping squares intersect by planarity. Thus their union contains a white path from a free vertex adjacent to the black boundary to a free vertex adjacent to the white boundary. Add a white–white edge at the white endpoint and choose an edge e to a black boundary vertex at the other endpoint. Trim the white path at its last white-wired-boundary contact before reaching the left endpoint, so that all its subsequent white vertices are interior; then erase loops. This gives a proper simple primal crosscut with just the one heterochromatic edge e.

All these vertices lie, allowing lattice rounding, in $A(0, r/2, 6r)$. The crosscut and the boundary arc through the source enclose the source patch. Its source-side component is inside $B(0, 6r)$: the crosscut and that local boundary arc form a Jordan polygon contained there, so their bounded interior is also contained there. The common half-annulus between the patch and crosscut shows that the entire altered domain portion of the source patch is on that side.

Each rectangle event is increasing in white colors of independent free vertices. RSW and FKG therefore give a constant $\vartheta > 0$, independent of r, δ and the contents of the source patch, for this white-arch event. Importantly, the left endpoint is *some* first-row white vertex adjacent to the black boundary, selected after the crossing occurs. Requiring connection to one predetermined microscopic vertex would not have this uniform lower bound.

Straight slit geometry. The same construction works for a finite-width lattice slit along the negative real axis, with black upper lip and white lower lip, by using five crossings around a square annulus: an upper-left vertical stem, a top horizontal crossing, a right vertical crossing, a bottom horizontal crossing, and a lower-left vertical stem. The stems occupy $[-3r, -2r] \times [0, 3r]$ and $[-3r, -2r] \times [-3r, 0]$ on their respective sides of the slit. The other three rectangles may be

$$[-3r, 3r] \times [2r, 3r], \quad [2r, 3r] \times [-3r, 3r], \quad [-3r, 3r] \times [-3r, -2r].$$

The first free upper row is adjacent to the black wired lip; the first free lower row is adjacent to the white wired lip. The resulting crosscut goes around the right side of the slit and separates its tip patch from the distant target. The boundary arc through the tip, including the two separate lattice lips, stays inside $B(0, 6r)$. The finite-width triangulated domain is Jordan; one need not identify its two physical boundary rows. RSW and FKG again give a uniform $\vartheta > 0$ after adjusting constants.

22.3 Polynomial source-patch stability

Theorem 22.2 (Common-color coalescence outside a source patch)**.** *Under the preceding geometric and percolation hypotheses, there are constants $C < \infty$ and $\alpha > 0$ depending only on the RSW bounds and the fixed geometry such that, for $0 < R < R_0/6$, the common-color coupling of the two full exploration curves satisfies*

$$\mathbb{P}\{d_{\mathrm{F}}(\gamma_1, \gamma_2) > 2R\} \le C \left(\frac{\epsilon + \delta}{R}\right)^{\alpha}. \tag{SH1}$$

More concretely, outside an event of the displayed probability the curves coalesce at a directed dual edge inside $B(p, R)$; both prefixes before that edge stay inside this ball, and the entire suffixes are identical.

Proof. Put $r_0 = 16(\epsilon + \delta)$ and $r_j = 16^j r_0$. For every j with $6r_j \le R$, the corresponding white-arch event depends only on shared free vertices in $A(p, r_j/2, 6r_j)$. These vertex sets are disjoint for different j, up to an immaterial lattice enlargement absorbed by increasing r_0. The events are

therefore independent and each has probability at least ϑ. If there are N available bands, the probability of no shield is at most $(1-\vartheta)^N$.

On any shield event select a white crosscut by a deterministic finite-graph rule using only shared colors, for example a lexicographic simple path in the crossing cluster. The two configurations select the same crosscut and the same single heterochromatic edge. Lemma 22.1 gives a common suffix. Before crossing the shield, each path stays in its source-side component, contained in $B(p, 6r_j) \subset B(p, R)$. Synchronize the two prefixes by any increasing reparameterization and then align their common suffix. The prefixes are in a ball of diameter $2R$, so their oriented Fréchet distance is at most $2R$.

The number of bands is a logarithmic function of $R/(\epsilon+\delta)$. For instance with $\alpha = -\log(1-\vartheta)/\log 16 > 0$, enlarging a fixed constant C gives $(1-\vartheta)^N \le C((\epsilon+\delta)/R)^\alpha$. This also covers the case with no available band by making its right-hand side at least one. □

Passage to marginal curve limits. Suppose along a common mesh subsequence the two exploration laws converge in the usual Polish oriented uniform-Fréchet curve space. The coupled pairs are tight because their two marginals are tight. Choose a joint subsequential limit. The set $\{d_{\mathrm{F}} > 2R\}$ is open in the product curve space; the Portmanteau inequality transfers (SH1), with $\delta \downarrow 0$, to this limiting coupling. Thus the same quantitative source-patch stability holds for the two marginal curve limits. It requires neither convergence of random slit-domain kernels nor a limiting strong DMP theorem.

If source patches themselves shrink and the mesh is negligible relative to their radii, this gives continuity in law for these particular local source perturbations. One may first fix R and let $\epsilon \downarrow 0$, then let $R \downarrow 0$, or balance the coupling estimate to obtain an explicit Prokhorov rate.

What is not proved. This is not a consequence of abstract unforced-crossing estimates for one curve. It uses a common independent coloring and the planar nonbranching interface to force *coalescence at one edge*. It also is not the full marked inverse-conformal-chart stability condition used in the affine-ansatz support theorems: arbitrary converging charts may create forced thin fjords, noncommon microscopic boundaries, or source approaches outside this shared half-plane/slit geometry. Extending the shield coupling to such approximations requires additional work. No classification of arbitrary source-local exploration ensembles follows from (SH1) alone.

23 Unsuccessful routes, revised objectives, and next experiments

Why several tempting arguments fail. Independent site colors give exact discrete domain Markov and locality at every occupation probability; these axioms do not by themselves encode criticality. Near-critical scaling limits are therefore natural candidates, but configuration convergence and a Markov theorem in the near-critical parameter do not establish the required ordered exploration kernels at random slit domains. We do not use this incomplete transfer as the main counterexample. Nor does singularity relative to isotropic SLE alone exclude an anisotropic affine image. A genuine dilation defect would do so.

A random mixture over fixed affine metrics is also not automatically domain Markov: observing the initial curve can update the metric posterior. The exact example avoids that failure through deterministic terminal information that remains visible in every current domain. This should be distinguished from unsupported claims that every stationary random environment yields a domain-Markov annealed interface.

Applying Schramm's usual Brownian-driving argument directly would silently assume that a conformally mapped slit domain has the same law as the original domain. Physical translations do not imply that premise. The deletion-chart identity above identifies the precise missing drift control. We have not proved that the original axioms imply semimartingale driving, driving martingales, or even a fixed underlying conformal structure.

A revised research question, not a proved classification. Restrict to nondegenerate continuous Loewner exploration laws with strong domain Markov, fixed-target locality, physical translation covariance, consistency under changing distant boundary conditions and target, and continuity under controlled Jordan-domain approximation, including changes near the terminal point. Require a genuine criticality condition, such as nondegenerate crossing estimates uniform over all scales, formulated for a common continuum coloring or a compatible exploration system. Does this force one deterministic conformal metric, and then affine SLE_6? Even the sufficiency of this strengthened collection is open here. One must not promote its plausibility to a theorem. Full similarity covariance alone is already defeated by the exact construction above.

Concrete priorities for the next session. The corrected-locality classification remains open. First seek regular driving characteristics in a suitable affine coordinate system, or a structure theorem avoiding semimartingales. The wrong-coordinate obstruction shows that this analytic input cannot simply be assumed in every physical complex structure. The drift-boundedness theorem identifies an explicit remaining regularity target, rather than deriving it from RSW.

Second extend the source-shield coupling from exact common flat/slit annuli to controlled tubular approximations of a simple slit, keeping source access and boundary-color order explicit. Such an extension could help derive the narrow straight-tip stability in the affine-ansatz theorem. It would still not prove that arbitrary marginals are affine SLE. General marked-chart convergence can have forced fjords and does not by itself give physical curve convergence.

Third establish strong limiting conditional kernels in random slit domains. The proved local-target transfer and source-patch marginal couplings do not settle that problem. Finally investigate whether metric information can be read from an unlabelled accessible frontier at every stopping time, or whether the corrected axioms prohibit it. An ordered initial trace decoder is not enough, and full Brownian support is not a substitute for stability at null deterministic histories.

Reproducibility and preservation. The concise project handoff is `STATUS.md`. The polished counterexample and global-deformation results are presented separately in `final.tex`. Independent scratch investigations and compilation products are under `work/`; this record contains the actual mathematical arguments and does not require the conversation or those scratch files to be understood. Successful LaTeX compilation checks presentation only. It is not evidence that a mathematical proof is correct.

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